VAMPIRE

PLAYER'S GUIDE



storytellers VAULT

A SOURCEBOOK FOR VAMPIRE: THE MASQUERADE

WoD

VAMPIRE

THE MASQUERADE



Vampire Player's Guide

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Introduction

"Men are born for games. Nothing else."

— **CORMAC MCCARTHY**, *BLOOD MERIDIAN*

The first time I played a World of Darkness game, I instantly fell in love with the character creation process. The level of customization available in addition to game mechanics tied to backstory choices changed what a role-playing game could be for me. Creating a character required telling a story rather than selecting a class or linear path. World of Darkness felt like a system that rewarded player creativity and I wanted to support that spirit with this Vampire Player's Guide for 5th edition.

Not only did I update some of the merit and flaw options from past editions, but I added my own to expand the selection of interesting choices. I hope these options aid players in fleshing out their kindred and making merits and flaws feel meaningful. This step in the creation process deserves to be highlighted and not simply an afterthought. My hope is that these can add exciting mechanics to character ideas and serve as inspiration for added depth to characters.

This philosophy also led to reviving the creation options of taking additional flaws to be used for extra merits. Balancing these background decisions serve to further build upon character concepts and provide an opportunity to explore the additional options provided in this book. Predator types and the hunger mechanic are brilliant editions to 5th edition, and these are supported with more options as well as an option to create a unique predator type for deeper customization.

Finally, I wanted disciplines to offer unique paths for characters to explore. My design philosophy for this was to allow vampires with shared disciplines to feel distinct from one another. The new disciplines were meant to feel more like paths or styles of using a discipline rather than simply add old powers or provide more "powerful" options.

Overall, this is a labor of love intended to expand upon one of my favorite parts of Vampire: The Masquerades, which is making character. Anything that feels imbalanced, not a right fit for your game, or goes against your lore can be tweaked or thrown out. Use this as scripture, inspiration, or a digital dart board. I think there are some great options in here to make the game I love even better, and I hope you do too.





Chapter One:

Predator Types

These expanded predator types seek to make use of the additional Advantages and Flaws offered in this book. While vampires can feed in whichever way presents itself, most develop a regular method of acquiring blood. A kindred's predator type informs a lot about the character ranging from how they interact with their Beast, how their past skills inform their new reality, and the relationship between their cursed existence and mortals.

Creating a Predator Type

Some vampires may hunt in ways that do not exactly align with the listed Predator Types. Players can work with their Storyteller to develop their own Predator Type. This should include a Predator roll determined by an Attribute and Skill, a dot of a related Discipline, 3 dots in advantages and 2 dots in flaws. This is not exact for Predator Types in the Corebook or this book, but is meant as a rough guide. Other adjustments can be made as necessary. Likewise, a player can use a Predator Type as a base and swap out specific aspects to better fit their character. Like everything else, this should be created to tell a better story and not to create a character intended to exploit the mechanics.

Example Predator Type

Explain how your character hunts for blood. Think of their methods, typical types of victims, or location they are best suited to hunt.

- Add a specialty
- Gain one dot of a discipline
- Gain three dots in advantages
- Gain two dots in flaws
- Determine the Attribute and Skill dice pool used for your Predator roll

Predator Types

Business Owner

You own a business or control it from behind the scenes. Either way, it provides staff and maybe customers available to feed from at your convenience. You most likely had a business in real life or worked for one in a position giving you knowledge of typical daily operations.

- Add a specialty: Persuasion (Deals) or Finance (Money Laundering)
- Gain one dot of Dominate or Presence
- Gain three dots in the Business Owner Background
- Gain the Routine Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Charisma + Leadership

Confidant

People open up to you. Sometimes you open their veins in return. You are in a position where people seek you our for advice, therapy, or to share their feelings with. Some seek comfort while others just want to unload their burdens on you. In life, you might have been a therapist, self-help guru, influencer, or simply that friend everyone confided in.

- Add a specialty: Insight (Empathy) or Academics (Psychology)
- Gain one dot of Auspex or Presence
- Gain the Beast Tamer Merit (•••)
- Gain the Conflicting Loyalties Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Composure + Insight

Corporate Leech

You have access to a corporate building full of inattentive workers to feed from. There are powerful people where you hunt, but you know how to manipulate the drones from the shadows without being noticed. Knowing how to blend in and stalk the halls and cubicles of capitalist labyrinths, you choose your victims carefully then put them back into the workflow. You know corporate jargon and enough details about a given company to get others to trust you belong there. Most companies have too many employees, departments, and divisions to know who is supposed to be in the building and who is a danger to them. Those who may suspect you do not belong rarely care enough to do anything about it. Perhaps you were a corporate drone in life, a manager in the rat race, security for a large company, or the one who cleaned the buildings.

- Add a specialty: Finance (Corporate) or Etiquette (Corporate)
- Gain one dot of Dominate or Obfuscate
- Gain three dots in the Power Behind the Throne Background
- Gain the Dull Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Manipulation + Etiquette

Eat the Rich

Eating the rich is not just a motto, it is your diet. You either have access to high society by pretending to work for them or are used to being ignored until it is too late for them. Maybe you were a member of the elite and know they make for a deserving meal. You also might have been part of the media whose job was to follow and report on those with all the money and power.

- Add a specialty: Intimidation (Extortion) or Politics (Media)
- Gain one dot of Fortitude or Potence
- Gain the Clan Infiltrator Merit (•••)
- Gain the Angry Beast Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Strength + Intimidation

Hide and Eat

You patiently wait for your prey to come to you. When the moment is right, you stealthily feed and disappear before most realize they stumbled into your trap. Whether you wait in carefully chosen neighborhoods, parks, or the back seat of cars, eventually a fly will find its way into your web. You likely have experience being undercover, stalking, or hiding from others more dangerous.

- Add a specialty: Stealth (Hiding) or Awareness (Ambushes)
- Gain one dot of Celerity or Obfuscate
- Gain the Efficient Eater (••) and Slippery (•) Merits
- Gain the Obvious Predator Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Composure + Stealth

Hospital Hunter

Hospitals provide a rotating selection of people in various conditions that often make for easy victims. You know enough about medicine to determine who can be fed from without complications. Your blood may even be of use to keep certain patients alive longer. Whether you blend in with staff, visitors, or patients there are various opportunities for infiltration at all times of the night. You must be careful as biometrics are monitored and abnormalities may lead to investigations. You might have been a doctor, nurse, or someone who spent a lot of time in hospitals in life or had someone close who was hospitalized for an extended period. These nights, you are a cursed angel or a spectre of death flowing through the hospital halls.

- Add a specialty: Medicine (Diagnosis) or Persuasion (Sympathy)
- Gain one dot of Fortitude or Oblivion
- Gain the Blood Healer Merit (•••)
- Gain the Frigid Aura Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Intelligence + Medicine

Kidnapper

Highly risky and not for vampires struggling with their morality, some kindred prefer to capture their prey and keep them for feeding until they expire or can be released in a way that will not breach the masquerade. This is likely not your first time doing these acts, or maybe you were fascinated with true crime and now have the means to be like the criminals you learned so much about.

- Add a specialty: Craft (Security) or Investigation (Stalking)
- Gain one dot of Dominate or Potence
- Gain the Base Haven Background (•••) with the Cell (•) and Security System (•) Merits
- Lose one dot of Humanity
- Gain the Sadist Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Resolve + Investigation

Lab Rat

You run a medical clinic, experimental facility, or organize alternative medicine gatherings were blood flows freely. For whatever reason, people willingly give blood to you and trust it is part of some greater purpose or for quick cash. Often times your subjects receive blood themselves for various experiments you are concocting. This is also a way to inject your prey with your addiction of choice. You could have worked in or ran a similar facility in life, frequently donated blood, or took part in medical trials.

- Add a specialty: Medicine (Experiments) or Science (Experiments)
- Gain one dot of Blood Sorcery or Fortitude
- Gain the Improved Ghouls (•••) Merit
- Gain the Blunted Fangs (••) Flaw
- Your Predator roll is Intelligence + Science or

Local Haunt

You are the real danger behind a local legend. The monster in the woods. The spirit in the abandoned home. The creature in the sewers. A local scary story ensures that the curious, bored, or brave explore a location deemed to be haunted in some way and where you know you can visit to feed. Of course most of the time people explore this haunt they find nothing. Some nights they find more than they bargained for. This may be your haven or a spot you set up specifically to hunt the morbidly curious. It may have already held rumors of danger before and you are capitalizing on it. In life you may have investigated the supernatural, or maybe just worked at haunted houses and know how to create an environment people will keep coming back to.

- Add a specialty: Intimidation (Frighten) or Athletics (Pursuit)
- Gain one dot of Oblivion or Protean
- Gain the Loremaster Merit (•••)
- Gain the Eerie Presence Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Composure + Occult

Lurker in the Crowd

You know how to move quickly and quietly while stalking your prey. Getting lost among the masses, these hunters pick a target from a crowd and feed before anyone notices something is wrong. You are not the best at making an impression, but you prefer it that way. You could have been anything in life, but most people would not remember it. You never stood out and that is how you liked it.

- Add a specialty: Stealth (Blending In) or Athletics (Escaping)
- Gain one dot of Auspex or Obfuscate
- Gain three dots in the Obscure Merit (•••)
- Gain the Outsider Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Wits + Stealth

Manic Pixie Predator

You are the predator of their dreams. Finding suitors is easy enough, but finding a new date each time you are hungry is not practical. Plus, you get something out of grooming your food with a short lived but passionate relationship. You are the manic pixie dream person who floats into your victims' lives and then leave them longing and lost. You may have been a heartbreaker in real life, or had commitment issues that never let you stay with one person for too long. Either way, finding eager partners was never a problem.

- Add a specialty: Persuasion (Taking Risks) or Insight (Insecurities)
- Gain one dot of Celerity or Presence
- Gain the Social Engineer Merit (•••)
- Gain the Cannot Embrace Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Manipulation + Persuasion

Online Predator

The internet can be a dangerous place for a vampire, but you know how to hunt for curious individuals who are less cautious. You may be able to find identifying information to locate easy victims in their homes. Sometimes you worry the same could happen to you. You may also cultivate relationships with locals and convince them to meet at locations where you can feed from them. You may have had a variety of jobs in life, but you likely spent most of your time online. This could have been the space where you socialized and found groups to become entrenched or where you lurked in the dark corners and found other internet rogues.

- Add a specialty: Technology (Doxing) or Etiquette (Choose an online subculture)
- Gain one dot of Auspex or Obfuscate
- Gain the Mask Advantage (••) plus either Zeroed (•) or Cobbler (•) Merits
- Gain the Paranoia Flaw (••)

Opportunist

Get-rich-quick schemes, miracle drugs, and other goods and services are constantly being pushed by advertisers and influencers. Savvy kindred have learned from these schemes and set up fake businesses or social media accounts to lure in desperate or naive customers to meet about an exciting opportunity. The vampires often leave satisfied while the target typically ends up worse off. You were likely a salesperson, con-artist, or influencer and now use your powers of persuasion to entice people to give up more than money for the promise of future rewards.

- Add a speciality: Subterfuge (Selling) or Finance (Investments)
- Gain one dot of Dominate or Presence
- Gain the Delay Destruction Merit (•••)
- Gain the Overconfident Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Manipulation + Finance

Pack Hunter

You hunt in the purest sense, surrounded by beasts while chasing down and ripping into your prey. There are other creatures who have come to accept you as one of their own, or even their leader, and hunt alongside you. Your active nights require deep rest during the day though. Besides, an apex need not worry about other predators. You were likely a hunter in real life, or someone who spent a great deal of time with carnivorous animals.

- Add a specialty: Animal Ken (Carnivores) or Brawl (Pack Tactics)
- Gain one dot of Animalism or Protean
- Gain the Apex Predator Merit (•••)
- Gain the Brash (•) and Deep Sleeper (•) Flaws
- Your Predator roll is Dexterity + Survival

Pay for Prey

Hunting is nothing particularly special to you, just another transaction to be completed or something you are too busy to bother with. You have the means and connections to have victims come to you and are accustomed to the convenience. The more people involved in supplying you victims the more chances for exposure or betrayal though. You likely come from a privileged past and are used to having people provide things for you.

- Add a specialty: Politics (Feeding Habits) or Finance (Follow the Money)
- Gain one dot of Blood Sorcery or Dominate
- Gain three dots in the Resources background (•••)
- Gain the Routine Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Manipulation + Finance

Street Feeder

You know the city streets well and the best places to find victims. Places others consider dangerous you call home. Rather than overpowering your prey, you lure them into vulnerable situations. You know the best areas to feed off the local population or where you can grab passerby's before sending them on their way. You might have been a person without a home in life, a busker, or off the grid.

- Add a specialty: Streetwise (Rough Neighborhoods) or Brawl (Ambush)
- Gain one dot of Obfuscate or Potence
- Gain the Danger Sense Merit (•••)
- Gain the Destitute (•) and No Haven (•) Flaws
- Your Predator roll is Strength + Streetwise

Watcher in the Water

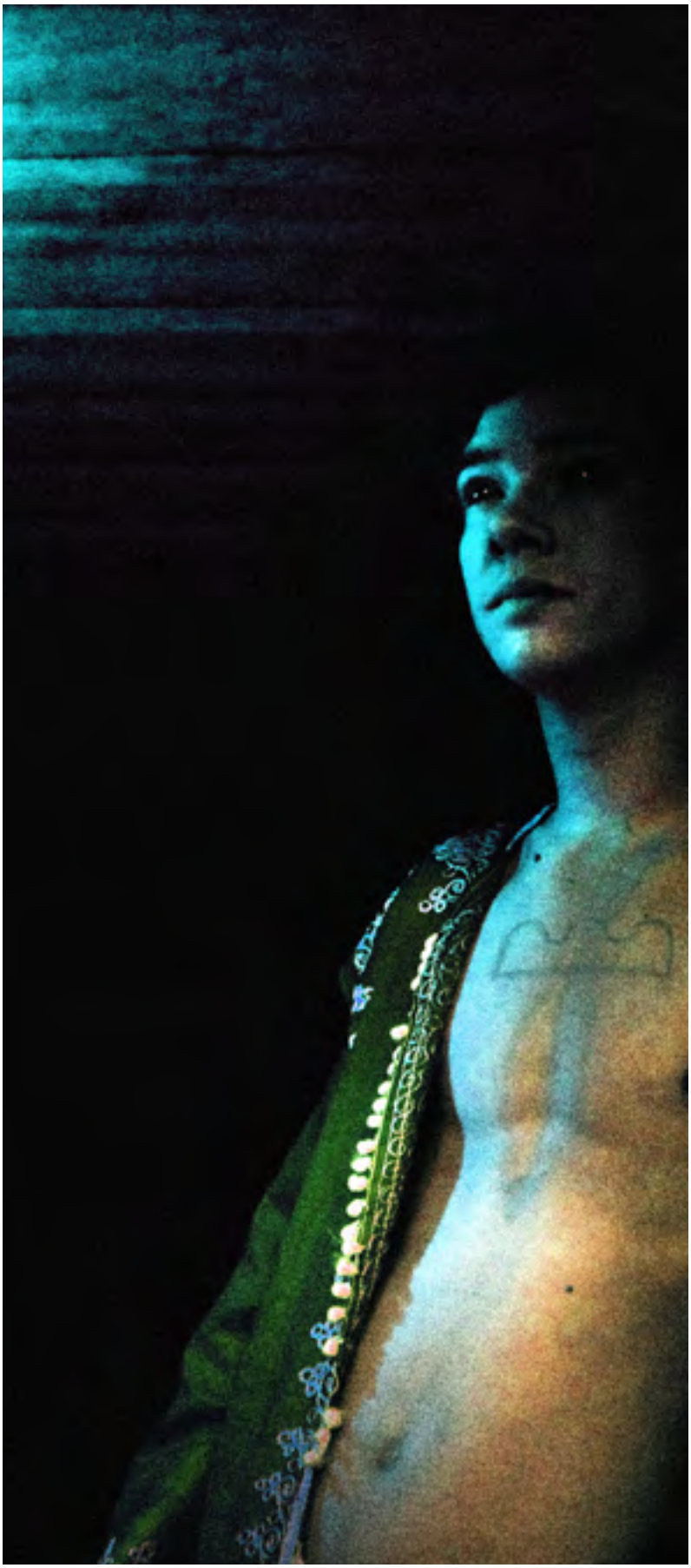
You hunt in a body of water for your prey. Accidents happen and it is easy for a vampire to wait underwater as long as they need for their opportunity. The depths are comforting to you. You feed on divers, fishermen, sailors, or anyone who finds themselves in or near your watery feeding depths at night. In life you were likely at home in the water and revel in the fact that you can now stay submerged indefinitely.

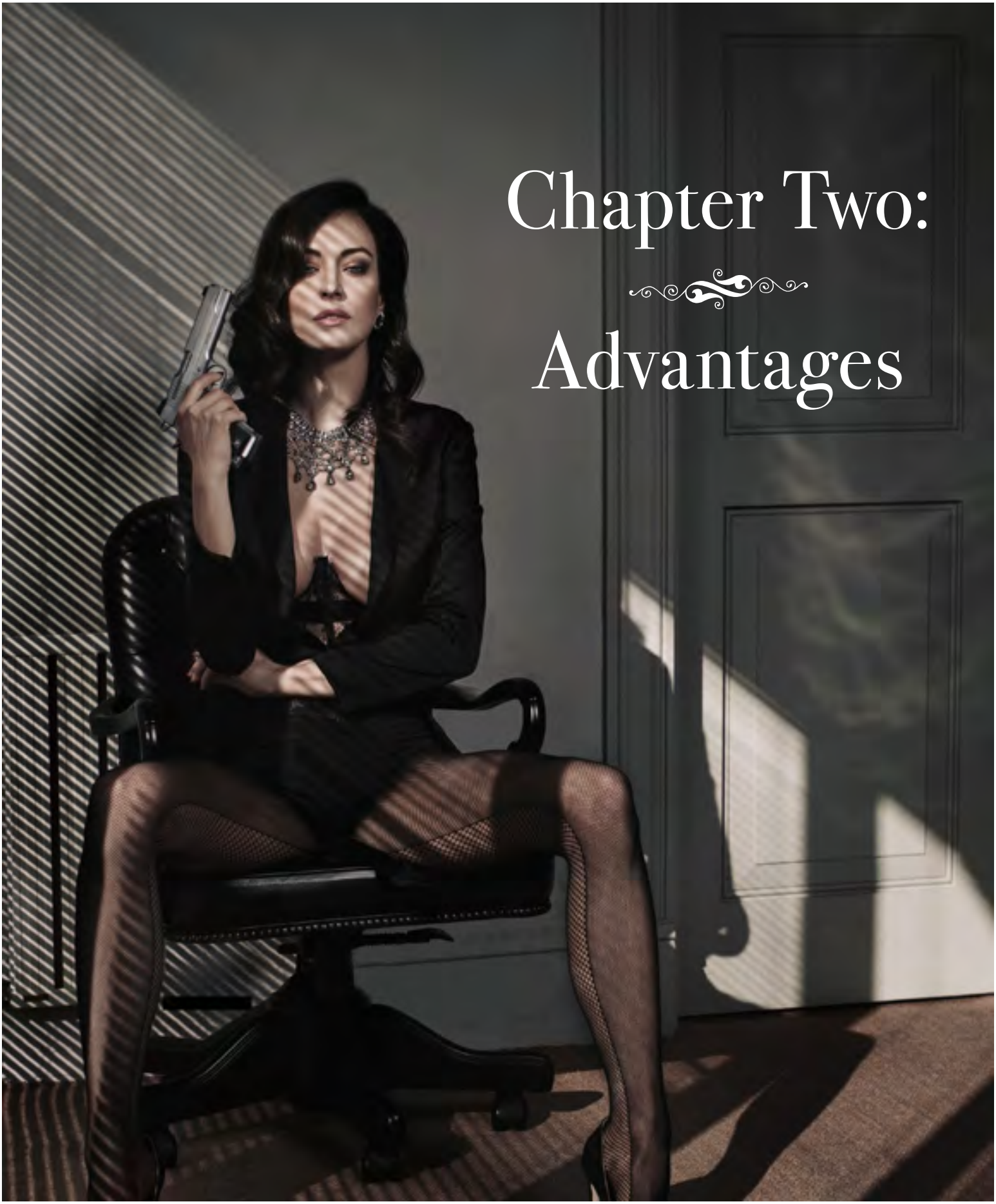
- Add a specialty: Athletics (Swimming) or Survival (Water)
- Gain one dot of Oblivion or Protean
- Gain the Sharp Senses (••) and Slippery (•) Merits
- Gain the Outsider Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Wits + Stealth

Wolf in Sheep's Clothing

You are the prey and the predator. You know how to find potential predators and flip the dynamic. By either pretending to be an easy target in key locations, or finding people in secret circles who seek out desperate people to take advantage of, you willingly walk into danger just to feed upon those who thought they had the power. Perhaps you have ran into some unsavory characters in your life, or were even one yourself, and now know how they operate and how to hunt the hunters often with a literal knife in their back.

- Add a specialty: Subterfuge (Feigning Weakness) or Melee (Sneak Attack)
- Gain one dot of Auspex or Fortitude
- Gain the Code of Honor (••) and Underestimated (•) Merits
- Gain the Death's Kiss Flaw (••)
- Your Predator roll is Manipulation + Melee





Chapter Two: Advantages

Merits and Flaws

While many Advantages (Merits, Flaws, and Backgrounds) can simply be played as character backstory, this section seeks to give unique aspects of your character weight within the game system. This is designed to add distinctive flair to your character rather than limit certain background details to mechanics. Ideally, these should ingrain your character concept within the game system. These options are intended to enhance role play rather than force narratives. Make sure your choices are adding depth to your character and not intended to exploit game mechanics.

Alternate Character Creation Rules

To make full use of the expanded Merits, Flaws, and Backgrounds it is best to increase the amount of points allocated at character creation. This optional rule allows up to 7 points of Flaws to be taken to acquire up to 7 points of Advantages. This is in addition to the standard 7 points of Advantage and 2 points of Flaws (or more if older) designated in character creation (VtM Corebook). For example, 4 points of Flaws can be taken in order to spend 4 points on Advantages. This would allow a standard character at creation to have 11 points of Advantages and 6 points of Flaws (not including those gained by their Predator Type). Merits can only be purchased using Flaws during character creation. Advantages must be bought using experience points as usual after creation. Advantages and Flaws are organized into Social, Mental, Physical, and Supernatural categories. Some expand on options available in the VtM: Corebook while others are new. Many add unique circumstances for your character to navigate, while others reinforce mechanics important to your concept.

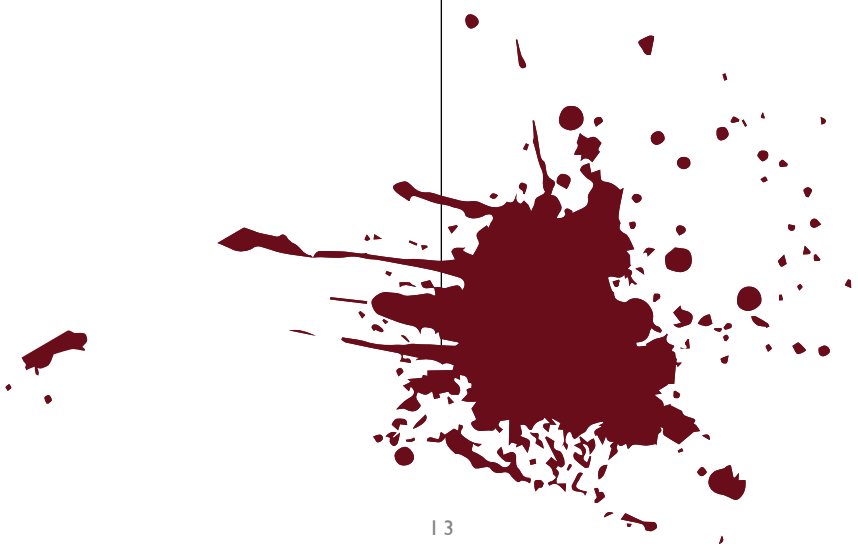
Mental

- **Flaw: (•••) Amnesia:** You remember nothing about your life before the embrace. Whether this is a side effect of the embrace, interference by mental Disciplines, or some other explanation, your life as a mortal is a blank slate. You still posses certain skills and knowledge from that time, but not specific details concerning your life.

••• Calm Heart: Your Beast has either been tempered or your overly calm demeanor makes it rarer to enter a Frenzy. Characters with this trait add two dice to any rolls to resist a Frenzy.

•• Code of Honor: You have a personal code that you adhere to at all cost. Any attempts to get you to break this code, even supernaturally, receive a two dice penalty. This code must be specific and defined with your Storyteller. Anything too vague or able to be broadly applied to most situations is not viable for this merit.

- **Flaw: (•••) Curiosity:** You must spend one point of Willpower to ignore something intriguing or to resist exploring something new or unknown.



••• **Daredevil:** Boredom creeps into the mind of many kindred over the years, causing some vampires to seek ways to feel more alive during their years of undeath. By risking their immortality, kindred with this merit pursue dangerous situations for gratification.

You have a two dice bonus for actions that the Storyteller deems unnecessarily dangerous. This does not give bonuses to just any dangerous situation a vampire finds themselves in or necessarily applies to every instance of combat, but adds to the chance for success when a vampire goes out of their way to take the most dangerous path in a given scenario. Danger being thrust upon them is not the same as chasing it.

• **Expert Instructor:** Some vampires understand that a strong coterie is vital to their survival and make sure they are surrounded by competent kindred. When you take the time to teach or train another character, they can spend one less experience point to learn a skill or Discipline that you possess. You can train others to gain ranks beyond what you currently have as well. The amount of time required training is determined by the Storyteller.

••••• **Fast Learner:** You are a natural learner, picking up new skills and knowledge faster than most. All experience point costs are one less for Skills and Specialties only. Skills are now new level x 2 and Specialties cost 2 experience points.

• **Focused:** Typically actions taken in especially chaotic situations are made at a higher difficulty or result in dice penalties. You are able to stay focused and ignore distractions that would be obstacles for others. You do not suffer penalties when performing actions under stressful or distracting situations.

•••• **Headstrong:** You possess impressive mental fortitude and are capable of pressing on where others would falter. You have one additional rank of Willpower (not to exceed ten) and do not take penalties for Impairment when your Willpower tracker is filled with Superficial damage.

•••• **High Humanity:** You were likely recently embraced and an especially righteous mortal. In rare cases, some vampires have even managed to lead a more moral life after the change. You gain one dot of Humanity.



■ Flaw: (••••) Impatient: You, or perhaps your Beast, is especially impatient. While many kindred bide their time for years while their schemes come to fruition, you struggle to sit around and wait for something to happen when action can be taken instead. You must spend a point of Willpower to wait patiently in a scenario where immediate action is also an option.

•••• Iron Will: You are especially resistant to mental intrusion. You receive a two dice bonus to resist any mind altering effects. If you successfully defend against a mind manipulating effect, you immediately become aware of the attempt. This does not combine with other mental blocking effects such as Fortitude.

•••• Jack of All Trades: You have a knack for nearly all skills either through versatile training or natural talent. You may treat any Skill that you don't have any ranks in as having one dot for the purpose of your dice pool. You still need to spend the normal experience point cost for the actual first dot in a skill.

•• Lore Master: You are well versed in various Occult interests. This may due to academic versatility, a practical dabbling in various practices, or access to impressive occult references. Whatever the reason, this merit allows you to add a specialty in Occult for each rank in the skill.

■ Flaw: (•••) Morbid Fascination: You have an obsession with the macabre and need to physically be in the presence of grim reminders of death. You must spend 30 minutes awake and in the company of corpses or other grisly remains at least once per 24 hours or take a two dice penalty to all dice rolls until you do so.

■ Flaw: (•••••) Nighmares: You are plagued with horrific nightmares every time you slumber during the day. This could be the same reoccurring nightmare or something different each day. There is likely a sinister reason for this occurrence. An outside force may be warning or punishing you, or something from your past has infected your mind and reigns terror upon you. When you wake for the night, you must make a Willpower test against a Difficulty of 3. On a failure, you take a one dice penalty on all mental and social rolls for the night.

■ Flaw: (••) Paranoia: It helps to be cautious in kindred society, but you are especially paranoid. You question everyone's motives and struggle to feel comfortable or safe in situations that you do not completely control. You automatically fail Insight checks as you assume the worst no matter what a person's true intentions may be.

• Remorseful: You add one dice to any Remorse rolls.

■ Flaw: (••) Routine: You find comfort in your habits. With a potential eternity before you, routines keep you anchored and give you purpose. While you take solace in this, it also makes it easier for your enemies to know where you are or what you will be doing. Whenever you are forced to break your routine for a night, you take a two dice penalty on all Mental rolls. You must spend a point of Willpower to willingly break your routine for a night. Define this routine and work out the details with your Storyteller.

■ Flaw: (••) Sadist: When others suffer, you feel a sense of joy. Once in combat, you will not stop until your opponent is defeated and you cause them as much pain as possible. Stopping requires a Willpower roll against a difficulty determined by the Storyteller. When given an opportunity to hurt someone or let them suffer needlessly, you must spend a point of Willpower to ignore the urge for a scene.

■ Flaw: (•••••) Soft-Hearted: Despite your Beast, you remain strongly compassionate to the plight of mortals. Whenever you witness a mortal suffering needlessly, you must make a Willpower check. The Difficulty is determined by the perceived innocence of the mortal and the severity of the suffering. On a win, nothing happens though you are extremely uneasy and saddened by the experience. On a failure, you take a Stain and have a two dice penalty to all rolls for the remainder of the night as you feel physically ill and emotionally distressed.



• **Total Recall:** You are able to perfectly recall anything you have seen or heard. While many memories fade as a vampire ages, this potentially allows immediate recall of specific details with a Resolve + Intelligence check against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller.

- **Flaw: (••••) Vengeful:** Revenge can be a dangerous game, but you or your Beast cannot resist a chance to enact your own justice on those who have crossed you. If confronted with someone who has wronged you but has not been punished for it, you must make a Fury Frenzy test at a difficulty determined by the Storyteller unless actively working to enact your vengeance.

- **Flaw: (••) Weak-Willed:** Your mind is more malleable than most. Perhaps you have always been easily swayed or maybe you have been mentally conditioned to receive instruction. You cannot use Willpower re-rolls when resisting mental powers or mundane

Physical

- **Flaw: (••) Blunted Fangs:** Your bite does not do Aggravated damage and is no more effective for feeding than a normal human bite, which is quite messy and painful for the victim.

- **Flaw: (•••••) Childlike:** You were embraced young. While the practice is heavily frowned upon in modern nights, your immortal form trapped in a young appearing body comes with many complications in both kindred society and navigating mortal society. Discuss with your Storyteller before taking this flaw.

• **Crack Driver:** You are an especially skilled driver. You can perform minor actions without penalty while driving and receive a two dice bonus on all Dice Pools related to driving.



■ **Flaw: (••••) Flesh of the Corpse:** You retain physical traces of wounds you receive. While a kindred eventually returns to the state they were in at their embrace, your undead body retains cuts, wounds, and other marks from injuries sustained. You can heal as normally, but the wounds remain visible on the surface. The more damage you take over time, the less human you will appear.

■ **Flaw: (•••••) Fragile:** Your form is more fragile than most kindred. Every time you take the first point of Aggravated Damage on your health tracker, you receive a crippling injury as rolled on the crippling injury chart (VtM Corebook). If you already have an Aggravated wound, you do not roll on the chart when you receive another. This only applies when you currently have no Aggravated wounds and then receive one.

••• Light Sleeper: A vampire is most vulnerable during the day. Luckily, you are able to shrug off your supernatural slumber and rise at the first sign of danger. Maybe you have trained your body to prepare for the worst or you just sleep poorly for some reason. You automatically awaken when in danger during your day sleep. You still suffer the penalties for staying awake, but do not have to make the normal Humanity roll to wake before nightfall (VtM Corebook).

• **Sharp Senses:** One of your senses is especially honed. You receive one extra die to all appropriate dice pools that rely on this sense.

• **Slippery:** You are especially slippery, either because of your nimbleness or even a literal slick coating that is found more commonly among the Nosferatu. You have a two dice bonus to escape from grapples.

■ **Flaw: (•••) Stench of Death:** The scent of decay lingers on you. It can be partially masked with other strong fragrances, but an odor reminiscent of death is always present. This smells different for each person, but evokes the same sense of dread. Any Charisma rolls made against mortals in your proximity are made at a two dice penalty.

•••• Tough: You are especially hardy. You may be an imposing physical specimen or you became tougher after the embrace. You have one additional health level.

••••• Unstakeable: One of kindred's greatest and most known weakness does not effect you for some reason. You may not even be aware of this unless you have been staked before. You do not succumb to Torpor when staked in the heart. While you take damage as usual from being staked, your body does not automatically enter torpor like most kindred.

- **Flaw: (••) Weak Stomach:** Vampires struggle to even fake eating and drinking as time goes. Most require Blush of Life to put on a believable performance even though everything tastes like ash. For you, this is unbearable and too repulsive to even pretend. You cannot even fake eating or drinking anything except blood. Anything you consume other than blood is immediately thrown up.

•••• Skill Aptitude: You are peerless in one specific skill, possessing incredible natural talent or the finest training in the world. You can go up to rank 6 in a single skill. You can only take this Merit once.

Social

- **Flaw: (•) Brash:** Double-speak, flattery, and veiled threats annoy you. If there is something to be said, you say it. You would prefer if others did the same, but that seems to be too much to ask; especially among vampires. You automatically fail any Etiquette checks that require you to practice restraint or subtlety.

••• Clan Infiltrator: In many cities, especially those under Camarilla control, a kindred's clan is an important identifier. However, there are many ways to hide one's clan or even masquerade as a member of a different clan. Kindred with this merit have successfully infiltrated another clan or have convinced most vampires that they are a different clan. You receive a three dice bonus on any Dice Pools to deceive others about your true clan.

- **Flaw: (••) Conflicting Loyalties:** You belong to separate factions with incompatible views or goals. You consider both allies and strive to find a way for them to work together. Simply leaving one or the other is extremely difficult, but it is only a matter of time until you will have to choose a side or the groups will make the decision for you.

- **Flaw: (••) Dull:** Most find you unremarkable and rather boring. Any rolls made to inspire or sway someone with Charisma are made at a two dice penalty.

- **Flaw: (•••••) Hunted:** You are known by the Second Inquisition, a Hunter, or an organization that exists to hunt your kind. They have your description and enough leads to begin tracking you down. It is only a matter of time until they strike unless you take measures to avoid detection. Even then, you can only delay the inevitable for so long and you are always at risk at being attacked by your pursuer.

• Inspiring Presence: Something about your aura is motivating to those around you. No words or actions are necessary, just your presence is enough to inspire others to do their best. Once a session, a single ally may make a free Willpower re-roll if you are within sight.

- **Flaw: (••••) Intolerance:** You hold a serious grudge against a certain clan or sect. You must spend a point of Willpower to cooperate with or aid any members of your hated group. This must be applicable to the story and not a group that there is little chance for cooperation with in the first place.

- **Flaw: (•••••) Marked for Death:** You have been marked for death by the Camarilla. Whether you broke a tradition, made an enemy out of a prince, or were framed, you are now at risk of death by the blood hunt whenever in the Camarilla's domain.

- **Flaw: (•••) Mistaken Identity:** You either look very similar to someone else or have been framed. You are commonly mistaken for another person who is notorious or disliked. Either way, you are often blamed for something you did not do or believed to be someone you are not. It is difficult to prove you are not this person and most operate under the assumption that you are the mistaken identity until proven otherwise.

- **Flaw: (•) Notorious Sire:** Your sire is a notorious figure in kindred society. You carry the burden of their reputation and must prove yourself or fight to get out from the shadow of your sire in most situations. While possible to hide your lineage, it is not overly difficult for crafty kindred to make the connection and spread the word of your dubious connection.

- **Flaw: (•) Oath Breaker:** You have a reputation as a liar not to be trusted. Whether earned or not, others are unlikely to take you at your word or enter an agreement with you in good faith.

- **Flaw: (••) Outsider:** You are an outsider. There are few in this place that have anything in common with you. You are adjusting to the customs, etiquette, and rules of your new surroundings. You have a two dice penalty to relevant rolls that rely on local knowledge or customs.



■ Flaw: (•••) Overconfident: You do not require help. In fact, you outright refuse it since you know you are at your best when handling a task yourself. You cannot receive a bonus to any rolls because of another character helping you nor can you provide assistance to another character on their roll.

• Prestigious Sire: You are the known childer of a prestigious kindred. Most kindred show you respect based on your lineage or at least hesitate to cross you due to your sire. You do not necessarily have to be close with your sire to benefit from their reputation.

••• Social Engineer: Bending another to your whim in the moment is useful, but you are especially skilled at carefully adjusting personalities and emotions to suit your needs. Manipulating mortal emotions is the equivalent of cooking for kindred. The right social ingredients tempered in proper environments can flavor blood to your preference or create Resonance. You gain a two dice bonus on any rolls designed to change a target's personality for purpose of shifting or cementing their Resonance.

• Stalwart Loyalty: You are devoted to a group and firm in your allegiance. Others know of your commitment and fellow loyalists commend you for it. It would be difficult to convince others you were acting against your faction's interest or not aligned with them. Once per session, you may make a free Willpower re-roll when acting in direct service to your group or resisting temptation to betray them. This group should be defined with the Storyteller and not be as simple as sect, coterie, or clan.

■ Flaw: (••••) Twisted Upbringing: Your sire taught you everything wrong about being a kindred. Whether this was done as a cruel joke or your sire is truly ignorant of the ways of the kindred, you believe their incorrect teachings and have difficulty accepting the truth of your condition and how kindred society actually works.

• Underestimated: There is something about you that makes others underestimate you. Whether this is based on a curated reputation, physical characteristics, or other judgements, you are not taken as seriously as you should be. This increases the difficulty of attempts to Intimidate others, but also makes you more difficult to read on Insight checks against your true intentions or capabilities. You are often overlooked until it is too late. Clever kindred will use other's errors to their advantage.

Supernatural

• **After Meal Glow:** Feeding fills you with fresh blood that naturally vitalizes your human physiology. Immediately after feeding, you gain the benefits of Blush of Life without the need of a Rouse Check. This only works when feeding from a living victim.

••••• **Alchemy Expert:** Whether through tutelage with the duskborn or perhaps stealing and studying their secrets, you have an understanding of their unique blood alchemy. You have access to the Thin-Blood Alchemy discipline. This is treated as an out of Clan discipline for determining experience point cost.

■ **Flaw: (••) Angry Beast:** Your Beast is always waiting just under the surface to rear its head. You make rolls to resist Frenzy with a two dice penalty.

••• **Animal Affinity:** Animals normally either avoid vampires or become aggressive towards them. Instead, they believe you are non-threatening and have a natural affinity towards you. You receive a two dice bonus on all Animal Ken rolls.

••• **Apex Predator:** Some struggle with adjusting to an existence of hunting for blood. You, however, are an especially efficient hunter. Maybe you honed these skills during your mortal life, or your Beast is the ultimate predator. When you are hunting your prey, no matter what your Predator Type is, you are at your best. You gain a two dice bonus on all Predator rolls to feed.

■ **Flaw: (••••) Appetizing Blood:** Your blood smells appetizing to kindred. Vampires in your presence have a two dice penalty to Hunger Frenzy checks and any nearby kindred in a Hunger Frenzy target you first. This also makes it more difficult for a kindred to stop feeding from you once they begin.

■ **Flaw: (••) Beacon of the Unholy:** Your aura is permanently stained with an unholy aura, acting as a beacon to those with True Faith and giving a sense of general uneasiness or even danger to those with religious leanings.

••• **Beast Tamer:** When an ally who can see or hear you enters a Frenzy, you may keep their Beast dormant as long as you concentrate solely on keeping them calm and neither you nor the potentially frenzying vampire take any other actions for a scene besides focusing on staying calm or leaving the scene for the night. You can do this once per night.

••• **Beserker:** You gain three additional dice on all Physical dice pools when in a Frenzy. Rolls to resist a Fury or Hunger Frenzy are made at a two dice penalty though.

••• **Blood Healer:** Ghouls benefit from from an expedited healing process, but are not able to quickly Mend wounds like a true kindred can. A vampire with this ability is able to heal a mortal with their blood. This requires feeding the mortal a Rouse check's worth of Blood which allows the mortal to heal Superficial damage equal to the same amount the vampire can mend according to their Blood Potency.

■ **Flaw: (••) Cannot Embrace:** For whatever reason, you are unable to embrace. Your Blood does not contain whatever property or curse that allows vampirism to be transmitted to another.

■ **Flaw: (••) Cursed:** Cursed by a vengeful mystic, forbidden item, or perhaps even from birth, you have an unshakable curse upon you. Choose one Attribute to be cursed. Every time you roll a Bestial failure or Messy Critical using this Attribute, the curse takes effect in that moment. The Storyteller determines how this curse manifests.

••• **Danger Sense:** Kindred with this ability have a supernatural sense for when they are in danger. When entering dangerous situations or about to be confronted with danger, the Storyteller makes a secret Wits + Awareness roll using the vampire's Dice Pool against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller. On a win, the vampire will get a sense of foreboding or sudden instinctual warning about immediate danger.

■ **Flaw: (••) Death's Kiss:** When you feed from a mortal, regardless of how careful you are, they take an Aggravated wound for each Hunger slaked. This is incredibly painful and makes it highly unlikely any victim would allow it to continue past the first bite.

■ **Flaw: (•) Deep Sleeper:** During day sleep, any rolls to wake up when in danger are made a a two dice penalty.

••• **Delay Destruction:** You can ignore a Bestial failure or Messy Critical (still failing or succeeding as normal). The next roll you make will have the negative consequences of a Bestial failure or Messy Critical regardless of the roll.

••••• Demonic Pact: You have entered a pact with a demonic entity. Your aura is permanently stained with fiendish influence. In exchange for your service and loyalty, you are given a dark gift by your patron. Work with your Storyteller to determine exactly what this is. These should roughly be equivalent to a rank three Discipline power but something outside of what kindred can normally do. Most kindred, and all uncorrupted werewolves, will seek your destruction if they discover you are in league with such an entity.

•••• Diablerist: Considered a carnal sin by mosts sects and quick way to lose grasp on one's humanity, nevertheless some kindred seek to commit diablerie and in fact are especially good at it. You gain a three dice bonus to all rolls required to commit Diablerie. The black veins that become visible in your aura never fade with time.

••••• Discipline Competence: You may treat one out of Clan Discipline as a Clan Discipline for the purpose of spending experience points. Either you have recieved special training or your blood contains a special property for some reason, but a discipline comes naturally to you that should not.

- Flaw: (•••) Discipline Inept: You are not able to take ranks in one of your Clan Disciplines. Choose one of these Disciplines at character creation. You cannot spend experience points or use any other means to train in that Discipline. This is usually seen as a sign of weakness by certain members of your clan.

- Flaw: (••) Eerie Presence: You are plagued by a supernatural effect such as an unnatural breeze, glowing eyes, forked tongue, insects follow you, or something unnerving and abnormal. The specific effect should be worked out with your Storyteller, but it should draw attention and complicate keeping the Masquerade.

••• Efficient Eater You are able to digest Blood more efficiently than most. Treat all feeding restrictions as one less than your current Blood Potency, no lower than Blood Potency 1.

••• Fast Eater: Feeding without grievously wounding the victim takes time when done properly. While some vampires can rapidly feed while causing severe injury or death to their victims, you have perfected the art of drinking quickly without causing additional harm.

•••• Fast Healer: You automatically mend one Superficial damage when you Rouse the Blood upon waking each evening. In addition, you can heal two Aggravated wounds when rising instead of one when making the required three Rouse Checks.

••• Friend to Fae: Normally a kindred's presence is disturbing at best to the fae. You instead possess a calming aura towards the fae, perhaps intriguing them or at the very least not repelling them like most of your kind. You are also able to enter Arcadia if given the opportunity unlike most Kindred.

- Flaw: (••) Frigid Aura: All kindred have cold flesh, but this chill seems to radiate from you. In your presence plants die, water slowly freezes, and the living can see their breath around you. You cannot use Blush of Life to appear more human-like.

- Flaw: (•••) Grim Wounds: You carry your wounds unlike other kindred, your form remembering the damage caused to it for some purpose. Mending requires two Rouse checks instead of one.

- Flaw: (•••••) Haunted: A spirit haunts you and wishes you harm or to suffer. Who the ghost is and why they haunt you is up to you or your Storyteller, but they are determined to make your life more difficult. This is not constant, but occurs enough to be a problem. You may use the Spectre (VtM: Corebook) statistics or adjust to fit the non-player character. The spirit is so strongly connected to you that it is immune to Oblivion powers or ceremonies that would cause it to stop haunting you permanently.

••• Holy Aura: For some reason, your aura reads as a mortal to those with True Faith. Other kindred able to read auras have difficulty identifying you for what you are. Those with divine abilities will not be able to correctly determine your nature with True Faith alone.

••• Improved Ghouls: Your blood is especially potent to mortals who consume it. Your ghouls can learn two level 1 Disciplines you possess, instead of the usual single power.

•••• Magic Resistance: You possess an inherent resistance to any arcane effects that target you, beneficial or harmful. Casters have a three dice penalty to any rolls to use magical abilities on you.

- Flaw: (••••) Magic Susceptibility: You possess an inherent weakness to any arcane effects that target you, beneficial or harmful. Casters have a three dice bonus to any rolls to use magical abilities on you.

• Memoriam Dweller: When you undergo Memoriam, you gain a three dice bonus on all rolls exploring the memories.

• to ••••• Obscure: You are mystically shrouded from notice. People have a hard time remembering you or even being aware of you in the first place. This is excellent for upholding the Masquerade, but makes it difficult to retain influence over a group when they often forget your name or deeds. This does not add dice to Stealth pools or effect people once they know you well or are consistently reminded of your presence. The higher the rating, the more potent and immediate this effect occurs.



••••• **Powerful Vitae:** Your Blood is more Potent in a specific way. Choose one of the following categories of Blood Potency (Blood Surge, Damage Mended, Discipline Power Bonus, Discipline Rouse Check Re-Roll) and treat the benefit as one Blood Potency level higher. You can only take this merit once and choose one category of Blood Potency to benefit.

- **Flaw: (•••) Repulsive to Animals:** Animals react especially violently towards you. They show clear distress and are vocal about their repulsion to your presence. Some bold or cornered creatures may even attack if given the opportunity.

••• **Rising Sun:** While most vampires make sure they are secure in their havens before the sun rises, some are able to push the limits of the curse and perform at their best in the final moments of the night. You receive a four dice bonus to any rolls made during a scene that takes place within half an hour of the sun rising while you are not in or near your haven.

••••• **Spirit Mentor:** A spirit companion guides you on occasion and seeks to help you on your journey. This may be the ghost of someone you knew, a friendly inhabitant of your haven, or another incorporeal being that took a liking to you for some reason. You may use the Spectre (VtM: Corebook) statistics or work with the Storyteller to determine the capabilities and background of this non-player character.

- **Flaw: (•••) Taint of Corruption:** Plants wither and die instantly around you. Small animals and insects even succumb to death if they come in contact with you. An unmistakable aura of death leaches life from everything immediately around you. Humans and larger creatures feel uneasy and ill around you, but do not take damage from this effect. This may grant a bonus to certain Intimidation rolls if deemed appropriate by the Storyteller, but prevents the vampire from using Blush of Life.
- **Flaw: (•••••) Tainted Blood:** Your blood is diseased, slowly killing any mortal who drinks it. This makes keeping ghouls or blood bonding mortals impossible. This does not effect other kindred or supernatural creatures though they can tell something is wrong with your blood.

••••• **Thaumaturgic Training:** You have been trained in Blood Sorcery despite not belonging to a clan with inherent skills in the art. You know up to 3 ranks worth of Blood Sorcery Rituals (three rank one rituals, one rank one and one rank two, or one rank three ritual). You can only take this if you have no ranks in Blood Sorcery and cannot take ranks in it later. You are considered to have Blood Sorcery 1 for the purpose of Ritual rolls only.

- **Flaw: (••••) Thirst for Innocence:** Your Beast seeks to feed on the Blood of the innocent. What qualifies as innocent is up to the Storyteller, but you must make Hunger Frenzy tests to resist feeding on an especially innocent individual when in their presence and at Hunger 3 or higher.

•••• **True Bond:** You choose one of your mortal Touchstones and are considered bonded to them. You can sense when they are in danger no matter the distance from you and receive a three dice bonus on any actions taken to directly protect them. You also recieve this bonus to any Remorse rolls for Stains involving them. You do not know the nature of the danger or their location, you just know when they are in danger. If this Touchstone dies, you automatically lose one point of Humanity and enter a Fury Frenzy the moment they die whether you witness this or not.

••••• **True Faith:** This extremely rare condition is only possible for a vampire with Humanity 8 or higher. You are able to possess True Faith (VtM Corebook). This allows access to all five ranks of True Faith, but this ability disappears if your Humanity falls below 8. If this happens, the ability returns if your Humanity reaches 8 again.

• to ••••• **True Sight:** While Auspex allows a vampire to see through illusions, some naturally have the ability to see more clearly. Characters may add their rating in this merit to rolls to see through illusions. This can be combined with the Auspex power Sense the Unseen.

■ **Flaw: (•••••) Weak Blood:** Your Blood is less Potent in a specific way. Choose one of the following categories of Blood Potency (Blood Surge, Damage Mended, Discipline Power Bonus, Discipline Rouse Check Re-Roll) and treat the benefit as one Blood Potency level lower, though no lower than Blood Potency 1.



Backgrounds

Business Owner

You either own or control a business. This could be anything from a small shop to pulling the strings of a major corporation. This business can be a venue, club, school, or anything that has staff and is intended to make money. The business may be successful, but that does not always mean money in your pocket. You may be able to funnel some money from the business, but are likely to draw attention to yourself or create problems for your business. The Resources background (VtM Corebook) still determines your capital assets.

- • Small shop that loses more money than it makes
- •• Small but successful business
- ••• Regional stores of very popular local spot
- •••• Major chain, corporation, or famous individual business
- ••••• Global corporation

Mystical Item

Some items carry ancient curses, potent sorcerous influence, or other supernatural effects. Whether passed down carefully to chosen successors, stumbled upon in a forbidden cave, or stolen from an occult collector, you now possess such an item. The exact nature and benefits of this item may not be entirely clear, but for better or worse it is yours to wield. Others will want to take this from you if discovered. Decide on the specific item and how you attained it with the Storyteller.

- • Weak effect or useful only in very specific situations
- •• Moderate effect, akin to a plus one damage for a weapon of its type or similar
- ••• Impressive effect, useful in many situations or able to mimic a level two Discipline equivalent
- •••• Remarkable effect, akin to plus two damage for a weapon of its type or especially deadly to a certain type of enemy
- ••••• Artifact, a truly powerful item that is especially lethal or able to mimic abilities similar to level three Discipline powers.

■ **Flaw: (•••••) Cursed Item:** The item has a negative effect in addition to any beneficial ones, or is tied to a powerful entity that wants it back. This can combine with a Mystical Item, or this could be an item you believe has a benefit that is instead only cursed, or simply an item you stumbled across and cannot get rid of.

Power Behind the Throne

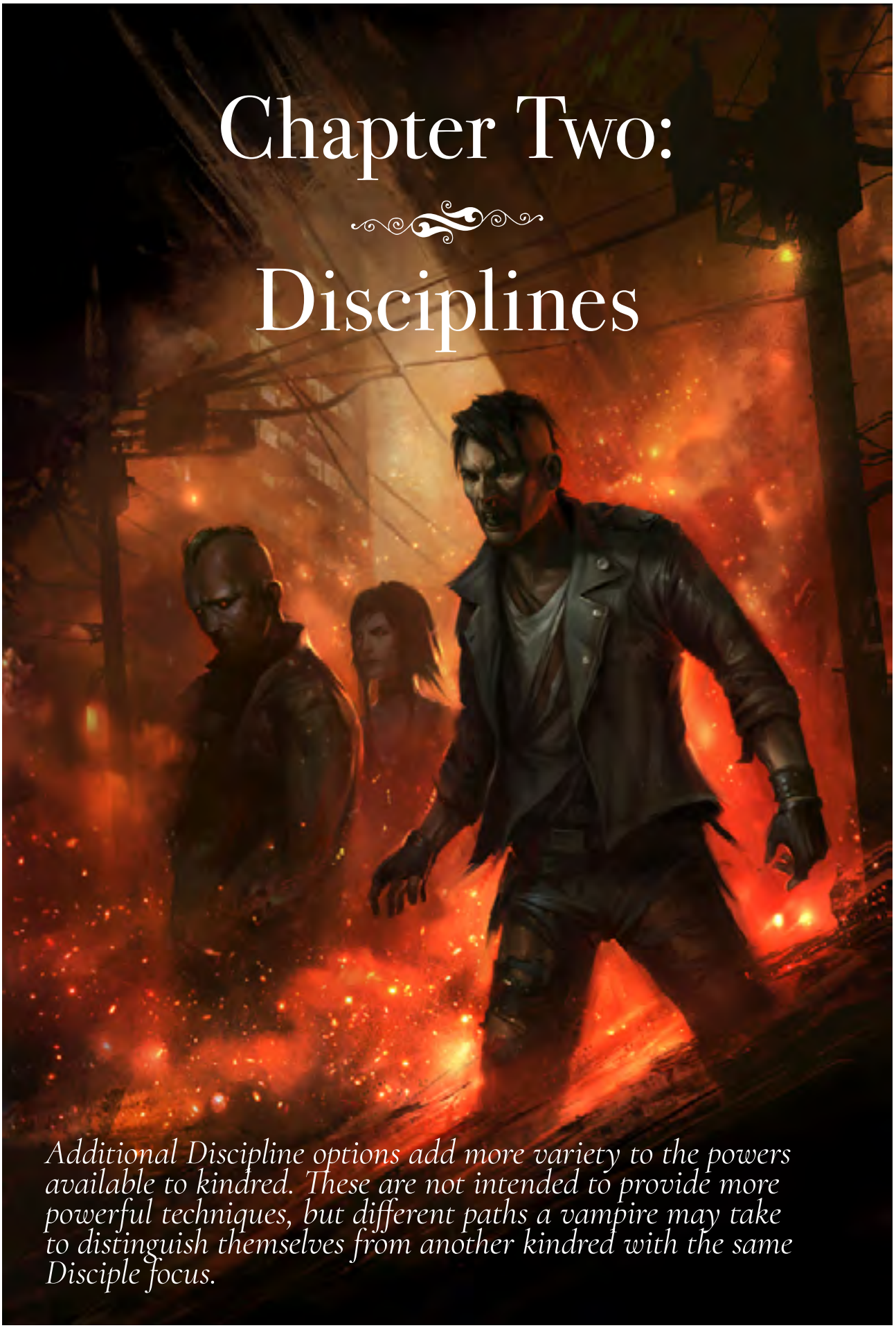
You are the power behind the throne, or the one whispering advice to someone with great potential. This Trait gives you sway over a particular character who is either in a position of power or well on their way. This person trusts you unquestionably, though believes their decisions are their own. What you stand to gain is up to you, but this person is sure to bring you with them on their rise to power or give genuine weight to your opinions if already seated in an advantageous position. They are unlikely to act directly on your behalf and will not fight your battles, but their influence may be yours to wield if used correctly. While they believe you act in their best interest, your true intentions may be discovered if you are brazenly obvious or exposed by an enemy. Write this individual on your Relationship Map when you buy this background.

- • Neonate
- •• Ancilla
- ••• Elder
- •••• Primogen or Anarch Revolutionary Council member
- ••••• Prince or Baron



Chapter Two:

Disciplines



Additional Discipline options add more variety to the powers available to kindred. These are not intended to provide more powerful techniques, but different paths a vampire may take to distinguish themselves from another kindred with the same Disciple focus.



Animalism

Level 2

Feral Frenzy

The user lets out a feral call, driving creatures able to hear it into a Frenzy.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Animalism
- **System:** The user makes a Manipulation + Animalism roll and lets out a feral sound, whether it be a howl, roar, or other animalistic call. The difficulty is determined by the natural aggression in the creature and availability of targets. On a win, the call incites Frenzy within all animals that hear it. The creatures are not under the kindred's control unless Feral Whispers or another discipline is used. The Frenzied animals will attack the nearest living creature of a different species (including the user), resorting to damaging property and possibly even their same species if no target is available. They remain violent for the scene or until destroyed, seeking out prey with little regard to their own safety for the duration. Even with Feral Whispers, it is impossible to direct the beasts to do anything non-violent and attempts to direct their fury is made at a three dice penalty.
- **Duration:** One scene

Hunt the Beast

- **Prerequisite:** Sense the Beast

The vampire can smell the essence of a supernatural Beast and track a target by scent. While following a trail this way, the hunter senses shifts to their prey's emotional state along their path as well. This allows the user to know locations where emotional changes took place. This ability can be used to track a specific Beast or smell the presence of any Beasts in the area.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Resolve + Animalism vs Composure + Subterfuge or Resolve + Animalism vs Difficulty determined by the Storyteller
- **System:** The vampire rolls a contest of Resolve + Animalism vs Composure + Subterfuge to track a specific target. A win allows the user to smell and track the trail of a supernatural Beast. The user can also smell the hostility of the target along their path. If tracking a target previously identified using Sense the Beast, the user has a 3 dice bonus to the contest. On a critical win, the user can identify the exact type of creature, as well as their Hunger or Rage level along the trail. If tracking in an area with multiple Beasts, the user can make a Resolve + Survival role to differentiate the trails without making another Rouse Check.

  To smell the presence of supernatural Beasts in an area without speci fying a specific target, the user rolls Resolve + Animalism against a difficulty determined by factors that would effect smell and time passed since a Beast was in the area. For example, smelling a Beast that was upwind within an hour in an area without strong smells could be Difficulty 2. Picking up the trail of a Beast that was near a landfill 4 hours ago could be Difficulty 6.
- **Duration:** One hour per margin of success vs a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller

Warn the Pack

- **Amalgam:** Presence 1

The user issues a warning about another vampire, marking the target as dangerous to those around them and causing them to come across as threatening despite their intentions.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Animalism vs Composure + Resolve

- **System:** The user calls out another vampire they can see as a threat and rolls a contest of Manipulation + Animalism vs the target's Composure + Resolve. On a win, the target receives a dice penalty equal to the user's Animalism level on any Charisma based checks (and receive a bonus for the same amount to Intimidation checks).

  The target gives off a dangerous predatory aura and their words are perceived as threatening for the duration. The user must remain within sight of the target to maintain the effect.
- **Duration:** One scene or until broken

Level 3

Howl of Rage

- **Amalgam:** Presence 2

As with Spark of Rage (VtM Corebook) but requiring Animalism instead of Potence.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Animalism vs Composure + Resolve

Mark Prey

The vampire can mark another kindred as prey, enticing those with a Beast to attack the target and receive advantages to do so.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Charisma + Animalism vs Composure + Resolve
- **System:** The user verbally declares their target, who they must be able to see, and rolls a contest of Charisma + Animalism vs the Composure + Resolve of a target. On a win, all vampires receive a bonus to Brawl or Melee attack rolls against the marked target equal to half the Animalism rating of the user rounded up. All criticals on attacks against the target are also treated as Messy criticals. The target must remain within line of sight of the user or the effect is broken.
- **Duration:** One scene or until broken

Level 4

Pack Frenzy

The vampire can turn a witnessed fury or terror Frenzy into a guided Frenzy by allowing a group of kindred to share the burden.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Wits + Animalism
- **System:** When the vampire must make a fury or terror Frenzy check, or witnesses another vampire succumb to a fury or terror Frenzy, they may make a Wits + Animalism to spread the Frenzy among any willing kindred they can see. To share their own Frenzy, the user rolls against Difficulty 3 plus 1 for each kindred accepting the Frenzy after the first. The amount of successes determines how many can share the Frenzy and the user need not choose how many allies are effected before rolling. The user automatically enters a Frenzy when using this ability and chooses not to resist. If they fail to share the Frenzy with others, they may not choose to Ride the Wave (VtM Corebook) and are instead at the mercy of their Beast and the Storyteller.

  An enemy kindred entering a Frenzy may resist having the burden shared with a Willpower test versus the user's Wits + Animalism. On a win, the user spreads the Frenzy with a number of willing targets equal to the margin of victory. The enemy entering a Frenzy still does so.

  The user may direct each ally in a manner appropriate with Riding the Wave of the Frenzy. Each kindred Riding the Wave under the direction of the user (including the user) adds 2 dice to all combat dice pools, plus an extra die for each additional kindred participating in the frenzy after the first.
- **Duration:** Frenzy duration (VtM Corebook)

Level 5

Subsume the Servant

- **Amalgam:** Dominate 3

The vampire can enter a trance and transfer their mind into the body of a ghoul with the user's blood in them. While mentally residing in the target, they completely control their form and can even operate during the day if they can stay awake. While controlling the ghoul, the vampire's body is inert and unaware. Multiple ghouls can be controlled simultaneously this way.

- **Cost:** Two Rouse Checks
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Animalism
- **System:** The user makes a Manipulation + Animalism test at Difficulty 4. On a win, the vampire's mind inhabits a ghoul's body (that currently has the user's Blood in them) for one scene. The user can control an additional target who meets the criteria for every success above the Difficulty.

  A critical win allows the vampire to possess the ghouls indefinitely though they must still make rolls to stay awake during the day as normal (VtM Corebook). Failure to stay awake ends the power. The user is not aware of their original body, but they are pulled back into it if any harms comes to their form. If any of the possessed ghouls die or fall unconsious the effect ends. The vampire takes two points of Aggravated Willpower from the trauma for each ghoul killed while being controlled.

  If multiple ghouls are controlled, they all must make take similar actions or speak the same words. For example, a group of controlled ghouls could all attack a target, but one could not operate a vehicle while another used a firearm or have separate conversations. One can act independently if the oth ers take no action.

  A vampire can use their own Auspex, Presence, and Dominate powers through the ghoul as well as whatever Discipline the ghoul possesses. Dice pools for a controlled ghoul uses the ghoul's Strength, Dexterity, and Stamina rat ings as well as Health Tracker. The user cannot use any other skills possessed by the ghoul and must use their own ratings. The vampire cannot access the knowledge or memories of an inhabited ghoul.

  After the ghoul is free, they take a point of Aggravated Willpower damage per scene they were inhabited and are considered Impaired for the next 24 hours. A ghoul may become comatose if they take full Aggravated Willpower dam age from this. Use of this power is often deeply violating to mortals and the Storyteller should consider giving Stains for the decision.
- **Duration:** A scene or until ended early through destruction of ghoul or harm to vampire body, indefinitely on a critical success





Auspex

Level 1

Lie Detector

While many vampires are masters of deception, this power gives the user the uncanny ability to know when they are being lied to by observing shifts in the target's aura when they subvert the truth.

- **Cost:** Free
- **Dice Pools:** Insight + Auspex vs Composure + Subterfuge
- **System:** Add the Auspex rating to any Skill roll involving Insight as well as to other rolls intended to determine if a target is telling the truth, at the Storyteller's discretion. Anyone aware that the power is being used against them can try to resist with a contest of Composure + Subterfuge vs the user's Insight + Auspex. On a win, the target can resist the effects for one scene; a critical win makes the target immune for the entire night.
- **Duration:** One scene or until intentionally ended

Level 2

Decipher

By reading the aura and intent of messages, a vampire can understand any language or code.

- **Cost:** Free
- **Dice Pools:** Intelligence + Auspex
- **System:** The user makes an Intelligence + Auspex test against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller based on the familiarity and complexity of the language or code.

  On a success, the user can understand these messages, but are not able to speak the language or write in the code. The vampire understands the intent of the message, not a perfect translation.
- **Duration:** One scene

Implant Dream

- **Amalgam:** Dominate 1

The user can implant a dream in a target, having a crafted scenario play out the next time the target sleeps.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Resolve + Dominate vs Composure + Intelligence
- **System:** The vampire either mentions a certain subject or concept or shows an image to their target and makes a Resolve + Dominate roll vs the target's Composure + Intelligence. On a win, the user implants a dream connected with the intended message or image that will be experienced the next time the target sleeps or enters torpor. This can be used to relay secret messages, frighten someone with horrific scenarios, or give them ideas that carry over when awake among other possibilities.
- **Duration:** Until the next time the target sleeps

Read Opponent

The vampire is able to read the intentions and subtle physical clues of their opponent, allowing them to more easily defend themselves in combat.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check, plus One Rouse Check for every additional target
- **Dice Pools:** Wits + Auspex
- **System:** The user makes a Wits + Auspex contest against their opponent's Strength + Subterfuge. On a win, the user may add their Auspex rating to any defense rolls against physical attacks from the target. The vampire must make an additional Rouse Check for each additional opponent targeted by this power. Dice penalties for facing multiple combatants still apply.
- **Duration:** One Scene

Sense Strengths and Weaknesses

Sometimes referred to as an appraisal, vibe check, or ocular pat-down, this discipline allows a vampire to read the aura of another and determine the strengths and weaknesses of their physical form, psyche, and personality.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Intelligence + Auspex vs Composure + Subterfuge
- **System:** Make an Intelligence + Auspex vs Composure + Subterfuge roll. On a win, the vampire can choose to learn either the strongest attribute or weakest attribute of the target. In the case of multiple attributes being tied for strongest and weakness, the Storyteller decides which is revealed among the chosen category. A critical win allows the user to learn both the strongest and weakest attribute possessed by the target including any ties.
- **Duration:** One turn

Level 3

Psychic Backlash

Some kindred are not only incredibly difficult to read, but they can create a punishing mental backlash to those who attempt to control them.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Dependent on Supernatural ability defended against

- **System:** Whenever the vampire successfully defends against any supernatural attempts to manipulate their mind such as through Dominate or Presence, they may make a Rouse Check to activate this ability. On a win, the user deals Superficial Willpower damage to the one who attempted to manipulate their mind equal to the margin of victory.
- **Duration:** One turn



Celerity

Level 2

Control Momentum

- **Amalgam:** Potence 1

After successfully defending themselves in combat, a vampire may use the assailant's momentum to direct the attack at a different opponent, even the aggressor.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Dexterity or Strength + Celerity
- **System:** During combat, after a successful Dexterity + Athletics contest to defend against a close range attack, the vampire may redirect the attack to a nearby opponent. The user makes a Dexterity or Strength + Celerity vs Dexterity + Athletics against the new opponent, dealing damage as normal on a win using any damage modifiers from the original attack. On a critical success, the user can instead turn an attack against the opponent who made the attack.
- **Duration:** One turn



Scan the Room

- **Amalgam:** Potence 1

With dizzying speed, a kindred can comb through details in a space and gather clues that could take others hours of investigation.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Wits + Investigation
- **System:** The vampire can carry out a thorough investigation of a room in moments, perceiving auras and physically investigating clues with supernatural speed so they can quickly act on their findings or gather information before others are able to. The user may add their Auspex rating to their Investigation roll as well as accomplish the task with supernatural speed.
- **Duration:** One scene

Level 3

Combat Tempest

Utilizing their supernatural speed to constantly move in combat, the user is able to more effectively face multiple opponents. This allows a vampire to avoid penalties to combat normally accrued when facing multiple foes.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** The vampire does not receive a penalty for defending against multiple opponents (VtM Corebook), gaining their full dice pool for each contest. This includes pools that add the Celerity rating if other Disciplines are in effect such as Fleetness (VtM Corebook). In addition, when splitting thier dice pool to attack multiple opponents, the user may add a dice bonus equal to half their Celerity rating rounded up to each roll.
- **Duration:** One round

Speed is Power

By building up speed, a vampire can increase the strength behind a single action using their momentum.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** Provided the user has the space to build up appropriate speed for the action, the vampire may add their Celerity rating to a single action requiring Strength that does not require the user to be stationary. For example, this could not be used to stand and lift a car but could apply to a Strength check to break a car door. This can also be used to bolster an attack and in addition to Potence abilities that increase strength.
- **Duration:** One action

Level 4

Furious Frenzy

When a vampire succumbs to any type of Frenzy, they move with supernatural speed and have multiple actions for the duration at great cost to their physical form.

- **Cost:** Free
- **System:** Upon entering a Frenzy, the vampire may choose to enter a Furious Frenzy and is able to make two actions per turn for the duration of the Frenzy. Any Criticals rolled during this state are considered Messy Criticals. After the Frenzy has ended, the user is physically Impaired and fills their health tracker with Superficial Damage. If the vampire was already Impaired before the Frenzy ended, they instead take a point of Aggravated Damage equal to the number of turns spent in Frenzy after Impaired.

  Advanced Combat Options: If using actions to attack a single oppo nent multiple times, the opponent would have to split their dice pool to contest each action as if facing multiple opponents. For example, they could attempt to fight back and split their combat pool between the two attacks they are facing from the user. If only defending, they would receive a one dice penalty per attack after the first. The user rolls their full combat pool as normal for each attack, or can defend with their full defense pool against two attacks before taking penalties.
- **Duration:** One scene or duration of Frenzy

Long Distance Journey

- **Prerequisite:** Blink

Vampires are able to maintain high speeds for longer periods of time, making longer distance travel on foot viable.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Stamina + Celerity

- **System:** The vampire makes a Stamina + Celerity check vs Difficulty 3. On a success, the user can run speeds up to 130 kph (roughly 80 mph) per dot in Celerity. They can maintain this for half an hour, plus an additional half an hour for every success above the margin. Additional Dexterity + Athletics checks may be required due to terrain or obstacles. A collision at these speeds may cause serious harm to both the user and whatever is impacted.
- **Duration:** Half an hour, plus additional half an hour for every success above margin



Dominate

Level 2

Declare Weakness

The vampire can convince a target they are weak in a specific area, causing them to mentally hinder their own natural abilities.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Dominate vs Composure + Intelligence
- **System:** No roll is required against an unprepared mortal. Affecting a resisting target or vampire requires a contest of Manipulation + Dominate vs Composure + Intelligence. On a win, the user chooses one of their target's Attributes and reduces it by half of their rank in Dominate rounded up. On a critical win, the user reduces the Attribute by their full Dominate rating. The Attribute cannot be reduced below one dot and this power can only effect one Attribute at a time.
- **Duration:** One scene

Level 3

Object Command

- **Amalgam:** Auspex 2
- **Prerequisite:** Compel or Mesmerize

The user is able to leave an imprint of a mental command on an object. This compels the next person to touch the object to immediately carry out a task specifically tied to the item. Only Compel and Mesmerize can be applied, with further effects to those abilities also applying (such a Submerged Direc tive or Rationalize).

For example, a brick can be imprinted with a Compel command to be thrown at the window across the street. A cell phone can carry a Mesmerize affect to be delivered to an address across town. The instruction must follow the same rules for the Dominate discipline used for the imprint.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Same as Compel or Mesmerize, depending on which is used
- **System:** The kindred touches an object and imprints a command upon the aura of the item. The next person to touch the item triggers the effect, resulting in a contest of Manipulation + Dominate vs Intelligence + Resolve. If the commanding kindred wins, the victim must immediately carry out the command regarding the object. The effect immediately fades after this and can only attempt to affect one target.
- **Duration:** One night. On a critical, the effect is permanent

Level 4

Mental Conditioning

The powers of Dominate can have long term effects of its victims. Some vampires take advantage of this and break down mental barriers through repeated use until it is trivial to impose their will on frequent targets.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** Whenever the vampire uses a Dominate power on a victim, but before they roll for success, they may make an additional Rouse check to add a lingering weakening effect to their target. If the Dominate power is successful, the user gains a breach in their victim's mind. Each time the user successful Dominates the target and Rouses the Blood to use this ability, they gain an additional breach. For each rank of breach a victim has, the user gains an additional die to Dominate them or socially control them through Manipulation or Charisma. The user can have a number of breaches per victim equal to their ranks in Dominate. For example, a vampire with Dominate 4 who has successfully used Cloud Memory on the same target 4 times without fail would receive a 4 dice bonus on Dominate abilities on social rolls on that target. If the victim successful resists a Dominate attempt or resists a social roll, they remove all breaches and the process must start over. A user can only earn one breach per victim a night.
- **Duration:** Until the target successfully resists a Domination attempt by the user

Level 5

Energy Vampire

- **Amalgam:** Oblivion 2

This power allows a vampire to leech the mental energy from their victim through casual conversation.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check per target
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Dominate vs Composure + Resolve
- **System:** After a conversation, even a one-sided talk from the user, the vampire may drain the Willpower of their target with a Manipulation + Dominate vs Composure + Intelligence contest. On a win, the user deals Superficial Willpower damage and is able to recover a number of Superficial Willpower damage equal to the amount drained. This power can only be used on a victim once per night and they will be aware of the mental exhaustion caused by interacting with the user after. This ability can be used on multiple targets at a time, requiring an additional Rouse check per victim. A mortal who becomes Impaired by this ability becomes lethargic. A vampire Impaired by this gains two additional dice to resist a Frenzy for the night. The user cannot gain additional Willpower past their total Willpower tracker.
- **Duration:** One scene



Fortitude

Level 1

Eternal Vigilance

The vampire can muster additional strength to resist the effects of daytime slumber.

- **Cost:** Free
- **System:** The vampire can add their Fortitude rating to any checks made to stay awake during the day.
- **Duration:** Passive

Level 2

Mental Vault

While the passage of time erodes many memories from aging kindred, those with this ability can store and protect important information for perfect recall and even protect the information from prying mental Disciplines.

- **Cost:** Free
- **System:** The vampire may store a number of memories equal to their Fortitude rating. Memories stored this way can be perfectly recalled and receive a bonus equal to twice user's Fortitude rating to be protected from mental disciplines or social coaxing. For example, a kindred can use this to hold a memory with a special touchstone from ages past, or perfectly memorize the blueprint of a building.

  The memory must be specific and something the vampire would be able to reasonable memorize on their own based on their Intelligence. The kindred can replace one memory a night, but may take willpower damage if choosing not to protect a particularly special memory.
- **Duration:** Passive

Return to Sender

The vampire is able to violently eject any foreign objects impaled in them, including stakes, arrows, or bullets.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Stamina + Fortitude vs Dexterity + Athletics
- **System:** After taking damage from a projectile that is still embedded in them, the user can supernaturally force the objects from their body and potentially harm any nearby targets by making a Stamina + Fortitude contest against the target's Dexterity + Athletics. The projectiles travel one meter/ yard per rank in Fortitude. The vampire has limited control over the projectiles, able to repel them the same direction impacted on their body but unable to aim if multiple people are within range. The projectiles do not receive a damage bonus (due to being damaged by the impact with the user) and instead do damage based on the margin of success. A vampire is unable to use this ability while in torpor.
- **Duration:** One round

Sleep Like Stone

- **Prerequisite:** Resilience

This ability fortifies a vampire in torpor and day sleep, making their inert form incredibly durable as a last layer of protection.

- **Cost:** Free
- **System:** When the vampire enters torpor or day sleep, they double their Fortitude rating added to their Health track through Resilience and treat all forms of damage as Superficial, even from fire and sunlight. They will still take Aggravated damage as usual after their Health tracker is filled with Superficial damage. This also allows the kindred to use other Fortitude Discipline powers while in torpor.
- **Duration:** Passive

Obfuscate

Level 3

Duplicate

- **Amalgam:** Presence 1
- **Prerequisite:** Cloak of Shadows

A vampire can create a duplicate of themselves that mirrors their movements. This effect causes observers to see an illusion of the user in an adjacent location. The actual vampire is mentally hidden as with Cloak of Shadows.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** No roll is required, although those able to Sense the Unseen (VtM Corebook) can discern the illusion with a proper test. Any sound the user makes seems to come from the illusion, allowing conversations and other nonphysical interactions. If someone were to physically interact with the mirror image, the effect would be broken. The first attack made against the illusion automatically fails, but also breaks the effect. The user may make a surprise attack using this power, but follows the same rules of surprise attack under Obfuscate (VtM Corebook) including ending the effect.
- **Duration:** One scene or until detection

Shape Aura

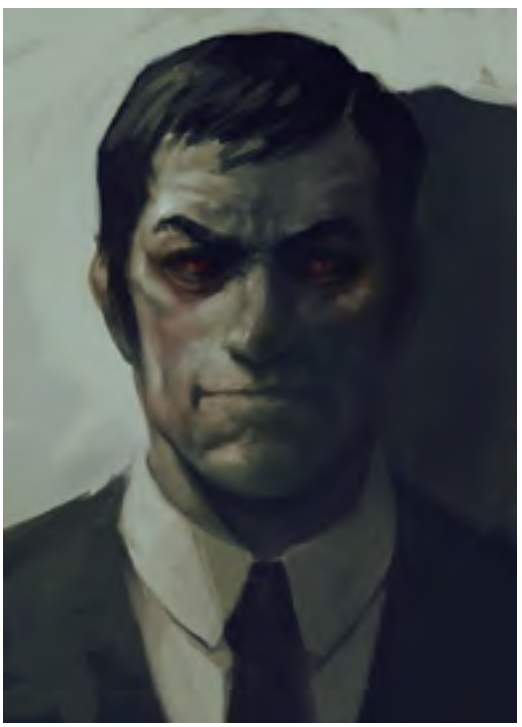
- **Amalgam:** Auspex 1

The user can obscure auras, masking their true essence and giving false readings to others who may perceive the psyche. The kindred manipulates details such as their emotional state, supernatural origin, whether they have committed diablerie, and other aspects. This can be used to mask aspects of a target's aura or plant false ones that may have dire consequences for a victim.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Obfuscate vs Composure + Awareness
- **System:** Make a Manipulation + Obfuscate vs Composure + Awareness roll. On a win, the user may make a number of changes to the target's aura reading equal to the margin of victory on the roll. This allows the various aspects able to be perceived with Scry the Soul (VtM: Corebook) and other supernatural senses to instead show false readings chosen by the user.

  The user may change their own aura by making a Manipulation + Obfuscate roll against Difficulty 3. This allows one change to be made, with each success beyond the difficulty allowing another change.
- **Duration:** One night





Level 4

Hidden Blade

A vampire can focus their powers of Obfuscation on a single weapon, blurring or misaligning it so it is difficult for opponents to track during combat.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Wits + Obfuscate vs Wits + Awareness
- **System:** The user rolls a contest of Wits + Obfuscate vs their opponent's Wits + Awareness. On a win, the user adds half their Obfuscate rating rounded up to Melee attack rolls. This ability can only be used on a single weapon at a time.
- **Duration:** One scene

Level 5

Fading Memory

The vampire masks the very memory of them, obscuring any details about the user someone tries to recall after a scene. Some use this effectively enough to make others question their very existence.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Resolve + Obfuscate
- **System:** After a scene has concluded, the vampire makes a Resolve + Obfuscate roll against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller. This could range from Difficulty 3 to make patrons forget ever seeing you lingering at a bar to Difficulty 6 for a group of rivals to forget how you embarrassed yourself at Elysium.

  The memory is not erased or replaced, but any details involving the user are heavily obscured and vague at best. This only affects memories directly related to the user and the user's involvement in them. This can only be attempted once and must be within 24 hours after a scene. The more time has passed, the more difficult it becomes.
- **Duration:** One scene





Potence

Level 2

Roasted

- **Amalgam:** Presence 1

One well placed insult, shut-down, or especially brutal comeback can turn the tides of any social confrontation. This allows the vampire to burn their opponent in a way that will leave lasting psychic scars that are not easily forgotten.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** For one scene the user can inflict Aggravated Willpower damage during social combat. The vampire's words carry lasting effects if they best another in a war of words.
- **Duration:** One round

Level 3

Fastball Special

Sometimes the best improvised weapons are one's own allies. The vampire is able to throw their accomplices into combat, transferring some of their raw power into their ally's attack. This can also be used against enemies, throwing them into a sturdy obstacle for maximum destruction or even into another enemy.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Strength + Potence
- **System:** The user makes a Strength + Potence to launch a target that they are strong enough to throw. If throwing an ally, the ally may make a close combat attack roll as normal and add half of the successes of the user rounded down as damage to their attack. This also negates any advantages an opponent may have to their combat roll due to superior reach. The vampire can throw an average person roughly a number of meters/yards equal to three times their Potence rating vertically and five times their Potence rating horizontally.

  To throw an enemy, the user must first successfully grapple them. If there is a solid object within range to throw them into, they can then make a Strength + Athletics contest, adding their Potence rating, vs the opponent's Stamina + Athletics. On a win, the vampire deals superficial damage equal to the margin plus half their Potence ratign rounded up and the object also takes the same amount of damage (potentially breaking). This can be used to damage two opponents by throwing one into the other. The enemy targeted by the launched target may make a defense roll following firearm dodging rules. The user can also use their Strength rating instead of Dexterity when using this ability to throw an object as a projectile weapon.
- **Duration:** One round

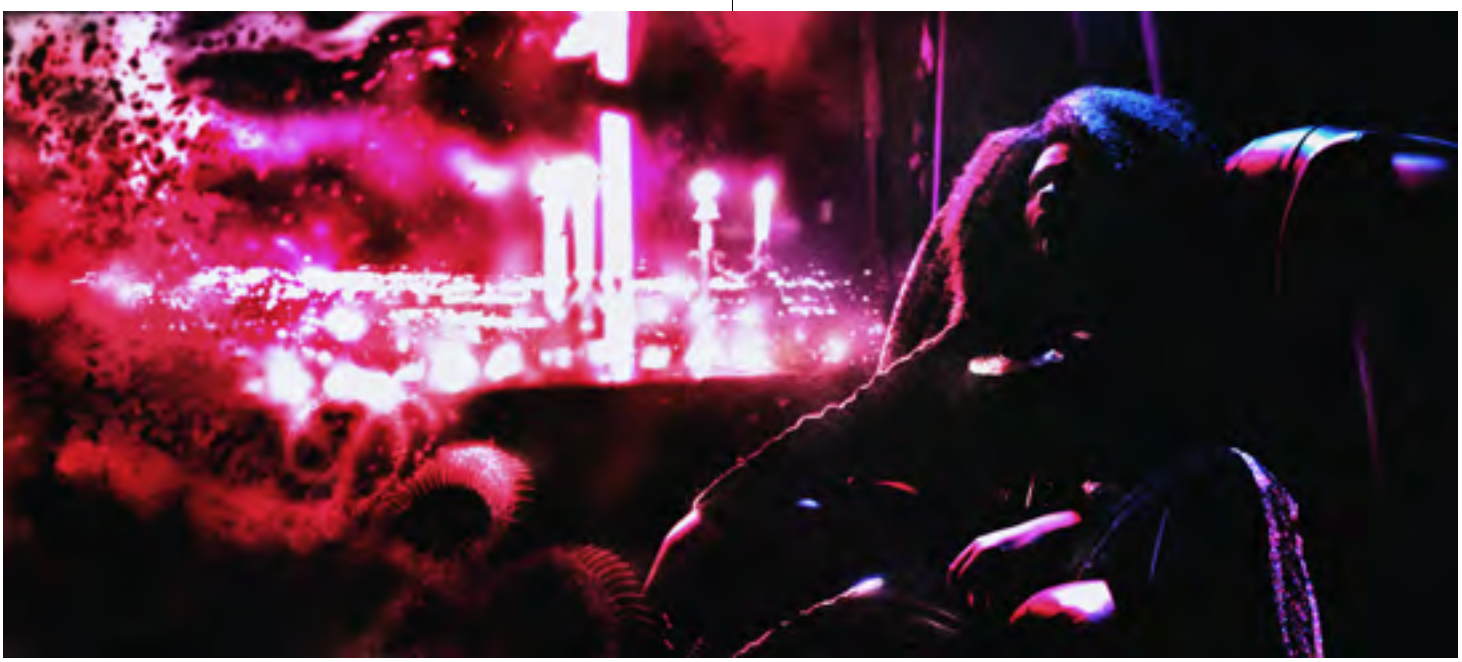
Presence

Level 2

Subtle Messages

The vampire subtly changes the emotional state of their target. Rather than causing intense emotions towards the user, this ability allows a kindred to manipulate a victim's emotions in a way that does not create an obvious target for their feelings.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Presence vs Composure + Wits
- **System:** The user must have the attention of the target and win a contest of Manipulation + Presence vs Composure + Wits. On a win, the subject begins feeling an emotion designated by the user though they are unsure of why and do not realize it is due to the vampire. By using subtle gestures and subliminal messages, the vampire can change the emotions of the target in a specific direction though not directed at a specific target. The victim may feel increasingly agitated, incredibly bored, or suddenly excited and act accordingly though not wildly out of their nature. They user can make a target feel increasingly paranoid, but not only paranoid about a specific person for example.
- **Duration:** One scene



Throne Room

- **Amalgam:** Auspex 1

By carefully arranging a space to send a message or convey an emotion, a vampire can turn the environment of a room into a conduit for their Presence. While in this space, the user can amplify and extend their otherworldly influence. Some create regal spaces to increase an authoritarian aura, pleasant parlors to put guests at ease and more easily swayed, or a macabre catacomb designed to unnerve and frighten.

- **Cost:** Free or One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Craft + Presence
- **System:** The vampire chooses a space to arrange. This could be their haven, a dark alley they bring victims to, a board room, or any space that can be arranged in a particular way without major disturbance. It must also be a distinct space, typically a room and not an entire building or anything too open and undefined. When in this designated area, the vampire may add their Presence rating as a bonus to any social tests as can any of their allies who also benefit from the carefully created ambience. No Rouse Check is required for this.

  By making a Rouse check, the vampire and their allies also deal additional Willpower damage in this space during social combat equal to half the creator's Presence rating rounded up. To extend these bonuses to your allies, the user makes a Rouse check and a Craft + Presence roll vs a Difficulty determined by how many allies you wish to benefit. For example, 3 successes would allow 3 allies to earn bonus dice to social tests and Willpower damage. No roll is necessary for just the user to benefit.

  Finally, the user gains the benefit of one free Willpower re-roll for social tests usable once per night while in this room.
- **Duration:** One scene

Level 3

Obsession

- **Amalgam:** Auspex 2

The vampire shows admiration or fascination with a certain person or object, creating a sense of obsession in their target towards the focus of the user's praise.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Manipulation + Presence vs Intelligence + Composure
- **System:** The vampire tells their victim reasons why they should covet, admire, or desire a certain person or object. This subject must be within sight of both the user and their target. The user then rolls a contest of their Manipulation + Presence vs the target's Composure + Wits. On a win, the target becomes obsessed with the subject and does everything in their power to be in its presence. They may seek to protect it from harm, or keep someone near against their will depending on the target and the subject of their desire. If this power fails, it cannot be used on the target again that night.
- **Duration:** One hour plus one per point of margin

Twist Words

By turning a target's own words against them, a vampire can let someone dig their own grave and socially break them down in front of an audience. This method allows a vampire to weaponize an opponent's words rather than come up with their own means of persuasion.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Wits + Insight
- **System:** When engaged in social combat in front of an audience, the user may use the target's social dice pool against the Wits + Insight of the audience member with the highest Charisma rating. On a success, the user appears innocent and earnest to the audience while their opponent's words are misconstrued and used against them. Contests won this way add half of the user's Presence rating rounded up to Willpower damage for the duration. Even though this uses the target's pool, it is the target who takes this damage. On a loss, the user takes the damage instead of the audience. This cannot be used without an audience and can only target one person at a time.
- **Duration:** One round

Level 4

Killing Joke

The vampire tells a joke or performs some sort of comedic act while instilling the desire to flatter the user, resulting in uproarious crippling laughter.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Charisma + Presence vs Composure + Wits
- **System:** The user needs the attention of their victim and to do or say anything that is intended to be funny and roll Charisma + Presence vs the target's Composure + Wits. On a win, the target immediately doubles over in laughter and continues to do so for one minute plus one per point of margin of success. While laughing this way, they are unable to perform any other actions or perceive anything except the user or subject of the joke. This ability can be used on multiple targets at a time, requiring an additional Rouse check per victim. If a victim is harmed during this, they are immediately released from the effect.
- **Duration:** One minute plus an additional minute per point of margin

Protean

Level 5

Mind Prison

- **Amalgam:** Obfuscate 3

Powerful kindred are able to trap a person in a false dreamlike reality of the vampire's creation, essentially trapping a victim in their own mind.

- **Cost:** Two Rouse Checks
- **Dice Pools:** Resolve + Presence vs Intelligence + Resolve
- **System:** The user makes a contested roll of Resolve + Presence vs the target's Intelligence + Resolve. On a win, the user describes a scenario or setting that the victim becomes mentally trapped in. The target is completely immobile and in a trance like state during this time, but fully accepts their new reality as it plays out in their mind. The user can choose to have their victim repeat a hellish scenario or go through what they believe is their usual routine. When they exit this state, they believe what they experienced was true though the truth may slowly come back to them as they put together the pieces.

  A user can repeat this each night to keep a target trapped, requiring the user to spend a point of Willpower and verbally reinforce their false reality in person with their victim each additional time.

  A victim may make a Wits + Awareness roll after their body takes damage to exit this trance, with a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller based on the severity of the damage (the more damage taken, the lower the Difficulty). The victim is considered asleep during this time, potentially withering away if they do not receive nourishment. A vampire still goes through the normal day sleep cycle, making rouse checks each night and potentially entering torpor through Hunger.
- **Duration:** Twenty Four Hours

Level 1

Shed Skin

A vampire is able to shed their damaged form and appear physically untouched even if they still have wounds. This allows a damaged vampire to not appear as a weakened target or able to quickly hide wounds from a recent encounter to maintain the Masquerade.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** A vampire spends a turn shedding their skin. This reveals a new layer of skin underneath that appears as the vampire does in perfect health. The shed skin instantly disintegrates. All physical evidence of their wound disappear despite still existing internally. This shedding can appear as a snake shedding their skin, a beast pulling damaged skin from their form, or any other animalistic way the user decides. This power cannot recover parts lost by Aggravated Wounds that have not healed.
- **Duration:** One night

Level 3

Tools of Nature

- **Prerequisite:** Feral Weapons

The vampire can mimic complex physiological features found in animals without fully changing physical form to become that animal.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **Dice Pools:** Resolve + Protean
- **System:** The user makes an Animalism + Resolve roll against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller based on the complexity of the alteration. A kindred could give themselves venomous glands to inject poison with their bite like a snake, develop echolocation senses, gain natural camouflage abilities such as those possessed by chameleons or octopi, or anything else the Storyteller deems reasonable without fully changing their form to fit the animal.
- **Duration:** One scene



Blood Sorcery

Level 4

Swarm Form

- **Amalgam:** Animalism 2
- **Prerequisite:** Shapechange

This power allows the user to instantly transform into a swarm of bats, birds, rodents, snakes, or insects.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** The vampire becomes a sentient swarm, able to use the senses of all creatures within it but unable to separate beyond a tightly clustered swarm. Otherwise, the vampire gains the Physical Attributes, senses, and native Skills associated with that animal and may use certain Disciplines while in this form at the Storyteller's discretion, such as those allowed with the Shapechange discipline. While not as physically dangerous as other animal forms, swarms are notoriously difficult to completely destroy and receive a bonus dice per dot of Protean to defense rolls. When the user takes damage beyond their health, they instantly revert back to their kindred form with the same health they had before becoming a swarm.
- **Duration:** One scene

Traverse the Earth

- **Prerequisite:** Earth Meld

While using Earth Meld, the vampire is able to travel through natural earth.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- **System:** While inside the earth, the vampire can slowly travel through natural earth following the same restrictions as Earth Meld. The user can travel at a walking pace and is able to percieve their immediate surroundings through supernatural means. Movement is not possible while in day sleep and they must surface through natural earth. They can move through any space with at least a meter of natural earth available. The vampire cannot use any Disciplines while in this form.
- Duration: Same as Earth Meld

Level 2

Blood Object

The ritual allows the caster to solidify expended blood, forming it into simple shapes.

- **Cost:** One or more Rouse Checks depending on size of object
- Dice Pools: Craft + Blood Sorcery
- **System:** The user Rouses the blood and opens a wound on themselves to create a small amount of malleable Blood roughly the size of a hand. This can be shaped into basic shapes, requiring a Craft + Blood Sorcery roll to shape their blood into more complicated objects. The item must be a simple tool and cannot be a complex machine requiring multiple parts. The consistency can be as hard as steel. The difficulty is determined by the Storyteller depending on the intricacy and hardness of the object.

  Each additional Rouse Check can increase the size of the object or create a new object. The object appears the color of Blood despite its shape and is unlikely to be passed off as the real object. Melee weapons can be created this way and have the same damage bonuses as their real counter parts. Objects created this way last for one scene before reverting to lan ichor unable to be shaped again. Blood objects are not able to satisfy Hunger.
- **Duration:** One scene





Blood Tendrils

The vampire is able to manipulate their blood into malleable tendrils, capable of delivering attacks that require contact with the user's blood and even manipulating objects.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- Dice Pools: Wits + Blood Sorcery
- **System:** The user opens a wound and forces a Rouse check worth of blood to flow. They can control a tendril up to their Blood Sorcery rating in yards/meters. The dice pool can also be split to create multiple tendrils from the same or different wounds. These tendrils can be used to deliver Blood Sorcery effects that require contact with the user's blood, requiring a Wits + Blood Sorcery contests vs the defender's appropriate dice pool.

  Each tendril can also be used to manipulate objects weighing 20 pounds or less. While manipulating the tendrils, the user cannot do anything else except other Blood Sorcery abilities. The blood must remain attached to the wound and is destroyed if severed or the wound is closed.

  The tendrils are destroyed if they take any damage as the liquid is easily disrupted thus the connection to the wound broken. They tendrils use the vampire's Wits + Blood Sorcery to avoid attacks and do so separately from the vampire and do not require the user's action. Another Rouse check replaces a destroyed tendril. These tendrils cannot satisfy Hunger.
- **Duration:** One scene or until ended or destroyed

Level 3

Dilute the Line

The vampire can dilute the Blood of another kindred, lowering their Blood Potency temporarily.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- Dice Pools: Intelligence + Blood Sorcery
- **System:** The user makes a Intelligence + Blood Sorcery vs Resolve + Stamina or Blood Sorcery on a vampire in line of sight while focusing for a turn and performing occult gestures. A win decreases the target's Blood Potency by one for that scene while a critical win decreases it by two.

  This can go below the generation parameters on Blood Potency during its duration. The target becomes aware that something malevolent has happened to their Blood. The victim can identify who afflicted them if they can see the user and succeed on an Intelligence + Occult vs the user's Wits + Subterfuge roll. Blood Potency cannot be lowered below Blood Potency 1 this way.
- **Duration:** One scene

Healer's Bane

The vampire can temporarily corrupt the healing properties of the Blood in another vampire.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- Dice Pools: Resolve + Blood Sorcery vs Stamina + Occult or Fortitude
- **System:** The user makes a Resolve + Blood Sorcery vs Stamina + Occult or Fortitude on a target vampire that they touch (potentially requiring a Dexterity + Brawl test). On a win, the target cannot mend their wounds for the scene. A critical win curses the target this way for the remainder of the night.
- **Duration:** One scene or oen night on a critical win

Level 4

Crimson Fury

This power allows the caster to transmute some of their Blood into a poison that potentially drives those who drink it into a Frenzy.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- Dice Pools: Manipulation + Blood Sorcery vs Composure + Stamina
- **System:** The vampire concentrates for a turn and taints their Blood with the enraging effect. The Blood retains this property outside of the user's body, but must make contact with the target's flesh to take effect. Upon contact, the user makes a contested Manipulation + Blood Sorcery roll vs the target's Composure + Stamina. On a win, the target must immediately make a Fury Frenzy test. A mortal immediately enters a violent rage following the same rules as a Fury Frenzy (VtM Corebook). The Blood is too viscous to inject with a syringe and does not mix with other liquids.
- **Duration:** One scene

Curse of the Slow Blood

The caster can dampen the effectiveness of the Blood in another vampire, causing them to require additional Rouse checks to activate the gifts of the Blood.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- Dice Pools: Resolve + Blood Sorcery vs Stamina + Composure
- **System:** The user rolls a contest of Resolve + Blood Sorcery vs the Stamina + Composure roll of a target kindred. The target must be within line of sight while the user concentrates and speaks words of power. A win requires the target to make one additional Rouse check every time they Rouse the Blood. The victim can identify who afflicted them if they can see the user and succeed on an Intelligence + Occult vs the user's Wits + Subterfuge roll.
- **Duration:** One scene

Level 5

Telekinesis

- **Amalgam:** Auspex 3

The caster can use their mind to manipulate physical objects and other people.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- Dice Pools: Resolve + Blood Sorcery vs Strength + Athletics
- **System:** This power allows a vampire to move an object that weighs up to 500 kg and within 50 meters.

  The object can be moved rapidly enough to damage a structure or person upon impact. To determine this, the user rolls a contest of Resolve + Blood Sorcery vs the appropriate defense pool of the target. Damage is determined by the margin of success plus additional damage determined by the object at the Storyteller's discretion. Small blunt objects are unlikely to do significant damage this way, but sharp objects or those weighing enough to crush someone would.

  The user may also target a person with a contest of Resolve + Blood Sorcery vs Strength + Athletics. On a win, the user can move the target 10 meters per point of margin, doing an equal amount of Superficial damage if thrown into another structure or object. To keep a target floating in the air, the user must make a Resolve + Blood Sorcery (Difficulty 3) each turn. Fine manipulation of an object requires a Wits + Blood Sorcery roll at a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller.
- **Duration:** One scene

Blood Sorcery Rituals

Level 2

Warning Against Trespassers

Careful casters perform this ritual to know when their Haven or other important locations are intruded upon.

- **Ingredients:** A length of string
- Process: The caster soaks the string in their Blood, lying it across any thresholds they wish to be alarmed while whispering the names of those allowed to cross. A section of the Bloodsoaked string must also remain tied to the caster to alert them.
- **System:** The caster places blood coated string across any threshold they wish to be alarmed. The space must be a doorway, window, or other entrance and does not work across longer areas of open ground. Whenever a creature passes this threshold, unless named by the caster not to trigger the effect, the caster is alerted of intrusion as the string on their person heats up. The string laid across the thresholds does not react when crossed. If the string is moved or tampered with in any way, the alarm is also triggered. The ritual remains active for twenty four hours. If this is triggered during the caster's day-sleep, the Difficulty is reduced by one for the Humanity roll to awaken.

Level 3

Addictive Vitae

The caster can prepare a substance that, once in contact with the target's skin, makes their blood more appealing to vampires.

- **Ingredients:** A small amount of narcotic substance
- Process: The substance is mixed with the caster's Blood and kept in a vial. Once the incantation is said, the substance becomes potent until it is applied to the target, up until the end of the scene.
- **System:** Make a Ritual roll when reducing the mixture. A critical win creates two doses of the poison. A dose can only be used on one target. The vampire knows if the ritual was successful upon completion. It retains its potency for a night and evaporates completely during the day leaving a fine red powder. The mixture activates after making contact with the target's skin. The target gives off an alluring aura to vampires, tempting other to feed on their blood. Any kindred within sight of the target makes Hunger Frenzy tests with a three dice negative and feels compelled to feed from the target first if they fail. Any kindred at Hunger 4 or above must make a Hunger Frenzy test at Difficulty 2 when first in the presence of the target.

Blood Homunculus

This ritual allows the caster to animate their blood into a small amorphous servant.

- **Ingredients:** A mixture of milk, urine, and an eyeball from any creature
- Process: The caster adds their blood to the mixture of ingredients, then reduces the concotion over a low flame while stirring constantly and chanting words of power.
- **System:** Upon a succesful Ritual roll, the caster gains a blood servant able to spy, follow, and obey other simple instructions at the sorcerer's command. If it strays farther than 100 yards/meters from the vampire, it falls inert until the vampire enters within that range. The create is active for a single night. On a critical, two such creatures can be created. Otherwise the creation of a new blood homunculus causes the previous one to smolder into dried blood. The creature appears as a pool of blood, and is able to squeeze through any spaces water could fit though it is slightly thicker. It can only grasp, move, or interact with objects that could be effected by a slow puddle of blood. The blood moves at a walking speed, but can travel across any solid surface (including vertically or upside down) without leaving a trail. It can telepathically communicate single images to its creator, but not make any noises or hear. A Blood Homunculus cannot satisfy Hunger when consumed.

Level 4

Alchemy

Performing this ritual allows a caster to transmute the properties of an object's form.

- **Ingredients:** Gold shavings, hydrochloric acid, sulfur, mercury, glass container, and the object to be transmuted
- Process: The caster places the object in a glass container able to hold it and mixes the ingredients with one Rouse Check worth of their Blood, covering the item while applying low heat, making small adjustments to the mixture to produce the intended changes. The ritual takes five hours to complete.
- **System:** On a successful Ritual roll, the vampire is able to make simple changes to an object's form such a hardness, color, and basic shape. More complex changes or major shifts require a Craft + Intelligence check against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller. Once changed this way, the object permanently retains its new properties.

Poison the Well

The caster creates a concoction that turns a mortal's blood poisonous to kindred. The potion has no effect on the mortal and is undetectable by the drinker until it is too late.

- **Ingredients:** Ash and honey
- Process: The caster mixes their Blood with ash and honey, reducing the brew over a brazier and chanting the appropriate words.
- **System:** Make a Ritual roll when reducing the mixture. A critical win creates two doses of the poison. The vampire knows if the ritual was successful upon completion. It retains its potency for a night and evaporates completely during the day leaving a fine red powder. When imbibed by a mortal, it has no discernable effect. Once imbibed, it mixes with the mortal's blood and creates a potent poison harmful only to vampires. If the mortal is never fed from, their blood returns to normal at the next sunrise. Every point of Hunger slaked this way causes 2 aggravated damage to the drinker as their veins blacken and smolder visibly beneath their skin. The damage does not take effect until a few moments after a vampire has stopped drinking. The poison is undetectable until then.

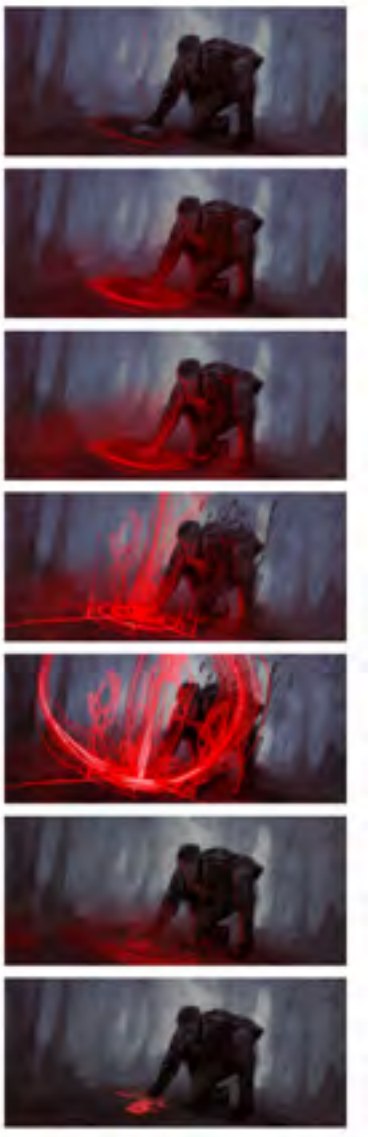
Level 5

Control Weather

This ritual enables a caster to create a concoction that can be evaporated into the atmosphere and change the weather in their area. This can be considered extremely vulgar if sudden unnatural weather patterns emerge.

- **Ingredients:** Rainwater, salts, belladonna leaves, iron shavings, a teapot
- Process: The ritual must be performed under the open sky. They caster adds their blood to the mixture and boils the ingredients in a teapot, saying words of power as the concoction steams and enters the air.
- **System:** Make the Ritual roll as the mixture begins steaming and evaporating into the air. If successful, a thunderstom begins centering on where the ritual took place.. This point does not change once the Ritual is cast. The area extends up to 25 kilometers and the storm lasts up to 5 hours. The vampire can create other weather effects by making a Craft + Blood Sorcery roll against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller.

A thick fog may be Difficulty 3 while strong winds able to damage some property may be Difficulty 6. The storm cannot reach levels of a hurricane or tornado though hail, high winds, and flooding can occur. Once the storm has been created, it remains in the determined state unless the caster makes another Craft + Blood Sorcery roll to alter. Small amounts of the caster's vitae can be found in any precipitation caused by a storm created this way, undetectable unless examined with scientific equipment. It is enough, however, to count as the caster's blood making contact with someone for the purpose of other Blood Sorcery abilities.





Oblivion

Level 2

Abyssal Pulse

By summoning the unnatural void of the Abyss, a vampire can temporarily disable electronic equipment in an area.

- **Cost:** One or more Rouse Checks depending on size of object
- Dice Pools: Wits + Oblivion
- **System:** The user makes an Wits + Oblivion roll against a Difficulty determined by the Storyteller based on the equipment targeted. On a success, the vampire disables all electronic machinery within an area of 1 meter/yard per rank in Oblivion centered on the user. Effected machines malfunction for a scene, but on a critical success the equipment is disabled for the night. A chilling shadowlike pulse erupts from the user, making this effect easily noticed.
- **Duration:** One scene, or one night on a critical win

Level 3

Shadow Puppet

While most who use the power of the abyss rely on their own shadow as a vehicle for Oblivion, some are able to control another's shadow and by extension control the target.

- **Cost:** One Rouse Check
- Dice Pools: Resolve + Oblivion vs Resolve + Composure
- **System:** When another creature's shadow is visible to you, the user may take control of it with a successful Resolve + Oblivion vs the opponent's Resolve + Composure. On a win, the user may use their actions to control the shadow as long as they can see it. Whatever the shadow is made to do, the target mimics. This can be used to physically control a target via their shadow, including having them attack. They cannot cause the target to activate new Disciplines or use the Blood. It is obvious when a victim is being controlled as the user makes gestures to control the shadow. The user must spend a point of Willpower after the first turn for each turn they spend controlling someone. This can only be used on one target at a time.
- **Duration:** One scene

Level 3

Witness the End

By consuming the eyes and ears of a corpse, the vampire is able to witness the last moments experienced by the victim.

- **Ingredients:** A mostly intact eye and ear of a corpse
- Process: Plucking the eye from the body and removing an ear, the vampire fills their mouth with blood while eating the sensory organs.
- **System:** After swallowing the eye and ear (one or the other can be used to only see or hear what the victim did), the vampire makes the Ceremony roll. On a win, the user goes into a trance and can only perceive the final moments as perceived by the cadaver before they died. The vampire can see and hear as the victim did while their own senses fade and their body goes into a torpor-like trance. Any harm done to their body allows the user to end the ability. They can also choose to end the trance at will.

  The trance otherwise lasts for 10 minutes per rank in Oblivion, allowing the user to observe this length of time before the victim died. This starts at the maximum time before death and ends at the creature's final moment. For example, a vampire with Oblivion 3 would enter a trance and begin percieving what the corpse did while alive 30 minutes before they died. The user can choose to shorten this time. This can be used on mortals, animals, and supernatural creatures.



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